Holiday ready: Practical strategies for advertisers

October 27th, 2026



Microsoft Advertising

Today’s speakers



Monica Orsino *(she, her, hers)*
Senior Learning & Development Manager



Kay Giza *(he, him, his)*
Senior Marketing Manager
EMEA Agency & Partner Marketing Lead



Federica Mueller *(she, her, hers)*
Manager Partner Development DACH,

The evolution of Microsoft Advertising

1995

1995

MSN launches

msn The Microsoft Network

2009

2009

Yahoo Deal

yahoo!

2016

MAY 2016

Microsoft acquires LinkedIn

2019

MAY 2018

Microsoft Audience Network launches

Microsoft

JUL 2019

Microsoft makes it's first investment in Open AI

OpenAI

2021

DEC 2021

International Expansion

Microsoft Advertising

2021

JUNE 2022

Microsoft invests in a SSP and DSP

xandr

JUL 2022

Netflix selects Microsoft Advertising to build ads plan

NETFLIX

2022

AUG 2022

Microsoft Advertising integrates as one brand

Microsoft Advertising

2023

FEB 2023

Microsoft reinvents search with AI-powered Bing

JUN 2023

Microsoft partners with Snap to power chat ads

OCT 2023

Microsoft closes Activision deal.

ACTIVISION BLIZZARD King

The world of Microsoft Advertising

Language options in Microsoft Advertising:
These language options in Microsoft Advertising give you control over your advertising campaign and experience.

188 Markets | 41 Ad Languages | 28 Platform Languages

The Americas: 47 markets

1. Anguilla
2. Antigua & Barbuda
3. Argentina
4. Aruba
5. Bahamas
6. Barbados
7. Belize
8. Bermuda
9. Bolivia
10. Brazil
11. British Virgin Islands
12. Canada
13. Cayman Islands
14. Chile
15. Colombia
16. Costa Rica
17. Dominica
18. Dominican Republic
19. Ecuador
20. El Salvador
21. French Guiana
22. Greenland
23. Grenada
24. Guadeloupe
25. Guatemala
26. Guyana
27. Jamaica
28. Haiti
29. Honduras
30. Martinique
31. Mexico
32. Montserrat
33. Panama
34. Paraguay
35. Peru
36. Puerto Rico
37. Saint Kitts & Nevis
38. Saint Lucia
39. Saint Pierre & Miquelon
40. Saint Vincent & the Grenadines
41. Suriname
42. Turks & Caicos Islands
43. Trinidad & Tobago
44. United States of America
45. United States Virgin Islands
46. Uruguay
47. Venezuela

Europe: 45 markets

1. Albania
2. Andorra
3. Austria
4. Belgium
5. Bosnia & Herzegovina
6. Bulgaria
7. Croatia
8. Cyprus
9. Czechia
10. Denmark
11. Estonia
12. Faroe Islands
13. Finland
14. France
15. Germany
16. Gibraltar
17. Greece
18. Hungary
19. Iceland
20. Ireland
21. Italy
22. Latvia
23. Liechtenstein
24. Lithuania
25. Luxembourg
26. Malta
27. Moldova
28. Monaco
29. Montenegro
30. Netherlands
31. North Macedonia
32. Norway
33. Poland
34. Portugal
35. Romania
36. San Marino
37. Serbia
38. Slovakia
39. Slovenia
40. Spain
41. Sweden
42. Switzerland
43. Türkiye
44. United Kingdom
45. Vatican City

Middle East and Africa: 54 markets

1. Algeria
2. Armenia
3. Azerbaijan
4. Benin
5. Bahrain
6. Botswana
7. Burkina Faso
8. Cameroon
9. Central African Republic
10. Comoros
11. Cote d'Ivoire
12. Democratic Republic of the Congo
13. Djibouti
14. Egypt
15. Eritrea
16. Ethiopia
17. Gabon
18. Gambia
19. Georgia
20. Guinea
21. Guinea-Bissau
22. Iraq
23. Israel
24. Kyrgyzstan
25. Lesotho
26. Libya
27. Madagascar
28. Malawi
29. Mauritania
30. Mauritius
31. Mayotte
32. Namibia
33. Niger
34. Nigeria
35. Oman
36. Rep. of Congo
37. Rwanda
38. Qatar
39. Reunion
40. Saudi Arabia
41. Senegal
42. Seychelles
43. Sierra Leone
44. Somalia
45. South Africa
46. Tajikistan
47. Tanzania
48. Togo
49. Tunisia
50. Uganda
51. United Arab Emirates
52. Yemen
53. Zambia
54. Zimbabwe

Asia Pacific: 42 markets

1. American Samoa
2. Australia
3. Bangladesh
4. Brunei
5. China
6. Christmas Island
7. Cocos Islands
8. Cook Islands
9. Fiji
10. French Polynesia
11. Guam
12. Hong Kong
13. India
14. Indonesia
15. Japan
16. Marshall Islands
17. Malaysia
18. Maldives
19. Mongolia
20. Nauru
21. Nepal
22. New Caledonia
23. New Zealand
23. Niue
24. Norfolk Island
25. Northern Mariana Islands
26. Pakistan
27. Palau
28. Papua New Guinea
29. Philippines
30. Pitcairn Islands
31. Samoa
32. Singapore
33. Sri Lanka
34. Taiwan
35. Thailand
36. Tokelau
37. Tonga
38. Tuvalu
39. Vanuatu
40. Vietnam
41. Wallis & Futuna

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https://aka.ms/Microsoft-Advertising

Discover what's possible

Microsoft Advertising is building a new world of advertising possibilities to empower growth for all.

Get started | Contact an expert



Powerful solutions for better results

Exceed your growth potential and reach billions of people online. Leverage Microsoft's new Bing and Edge, driven by the power of generative artificial intelligence (AI). Expand horizons with our exclusive partnerships: Ecosia, DuckDuckGo, and Yahoo, and beyond on the open web. Cut through and connect everywhere, anyhow with Microsoft Advertising.

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Discover
- AI Economy Hub
- Case studies
- Insights
- Marketing with Purpose
- Webcasts

Learn
- Certifications
- Free consultation
- Insider newsletter
- Learning Lab

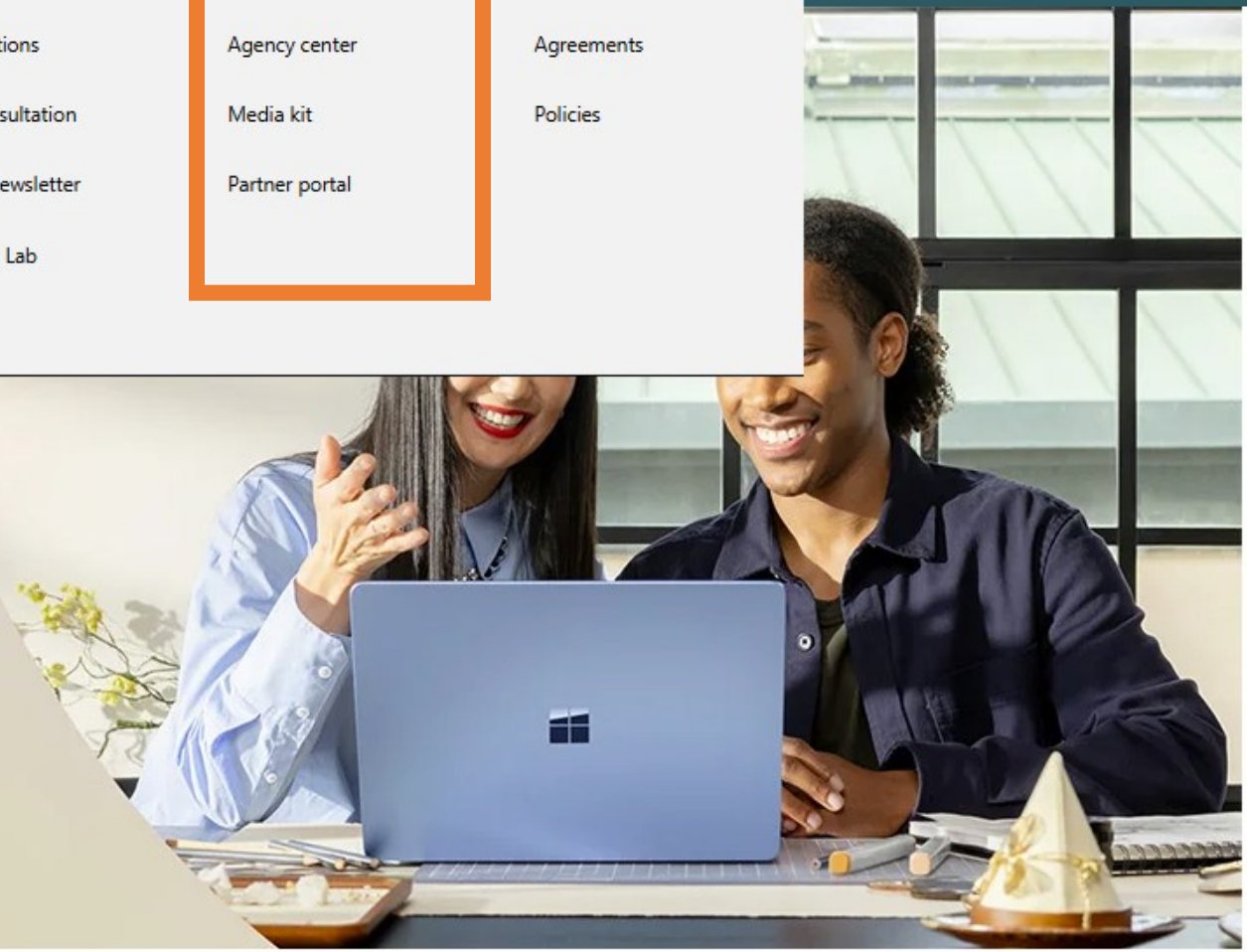
Partners and Agencies
- Agency center
- Media kit
- Partner portal

Legal
- Agreements
- Policies

Discover what's possible

Microsoft Advertising is building a new world of advertising possibilities to empower growth for all.

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Powerful solutions for better results

Exceed your growth potential and reach billions of people online. Leverage Microsoft's new Bing and Edge, driven by the power of generative artificial intelligence (AI). Expand horizons with our exclusive partnerships: Ecosia, DuckDuckGo, and Yahoo, and beyond on the open web. Cut through and connect everywhere, anyhow with Microsoft Advertising.

REIMAGINING ENGAGEMENT

Unmatched scale, across a diverse ecosystem, powered by Copilot

Search

+500M
Unique monthly visitors

Browser

#2
Largest desktop browser

Content

#1
desktop news and information service

+550M
monthly readers

Gen AI

+140M
daily active users

Social

+1.3B
members

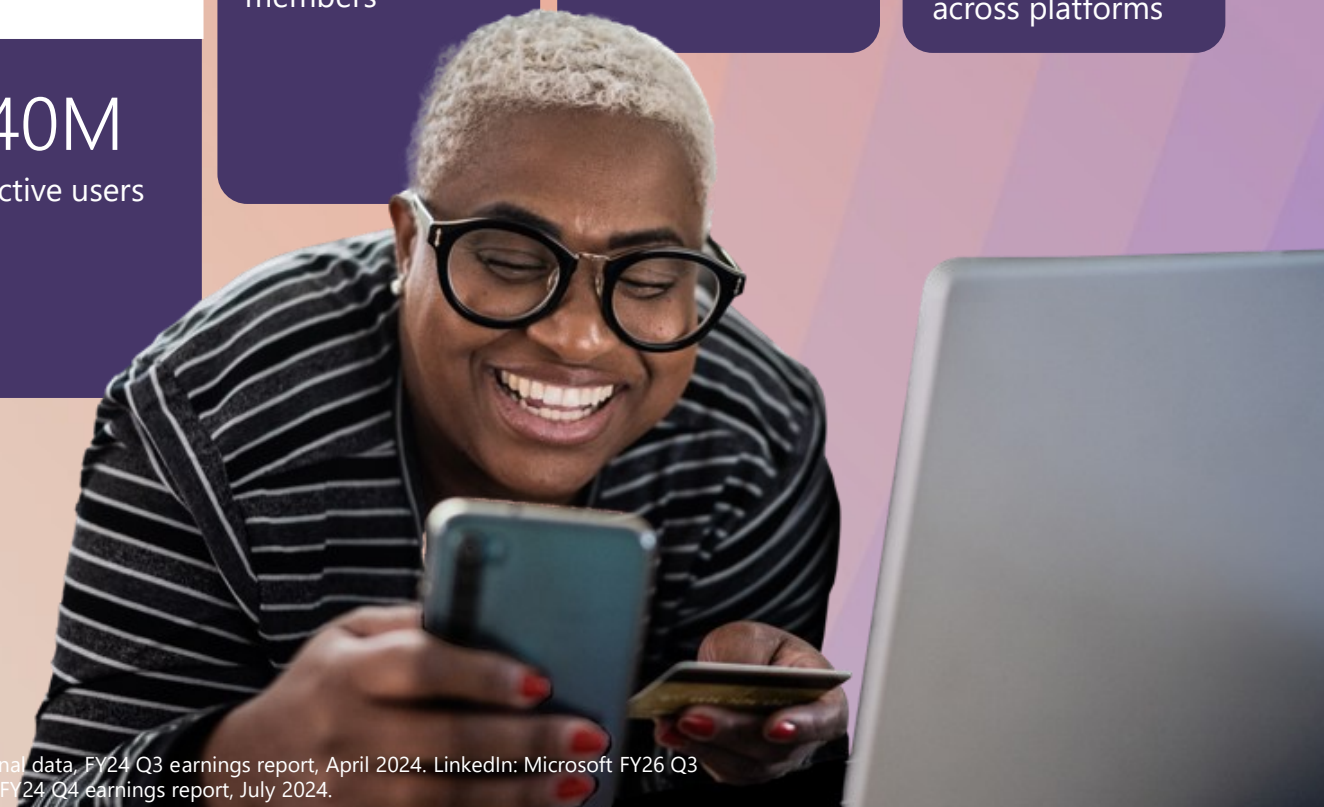
Email

#2
largest mail service

+180M
monthly users

Gaming

#1
most-played video game of all time (Solitaire)
+500M monthly game players across platforms



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Sources: MSN: ComScore, Global Data, Oct 2024. Outlook: ComScore, Global Data, October 2024. GenAI: Microsoft internal data, FY24 Q3 earnings report, April 2024. LinkedIn: Microsoft FY26 Q3 earnings call, April 2026. Search: comScore Search, Explicit Core Search (PC), June 2024. Gaming: Microsoft internal data, FY24 Q4 earnings report, July 2024.

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Winning holiday moments: **Practical strategies for seasonal success**



Best practices this holiday - Agenda

1

Phase 1 – Wrap the Basics – Foundation readiness

Product Feeds, Measurement, and Bidding Foundations

2

Phase 2 – Gift them a Reason – Demand creation

Create Consideration Early

3

Phase 3 – Ring in the Sales – Peak capture

Capture the Holiday Moment

4

Phase 4 – Unbox What's Next – Measurement & learning

Measure results, uncover learnings, pivot messaging, capture post-holiday demand and maximize post-holiday opportunities.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

What you'll be able to do this holiday season

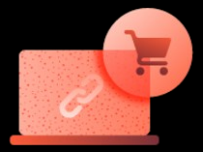
1. **Phase 01 · Prepare** your foundation — establish AI readiness (Microsoft Clarity, AI-ready feed), validate conversion tracking, and structure your full-funnel campaign mix across Search, Shopping, PMax, and AI Max before demand builds.

2. **Phase 02 · Engage** shoppers early — develop audience strategies (LinkedIn, seasonal in-market, remarketing), add search themes as signals, pursue new customers, and refresh creative to build demand before peak.

3. **Phase 03 · Capture** peak demand using automated bidding, seasonality adjustments, and conversion value rules during Cyber Week.

4. **Phase 04 · Measure** and learn by evaluating results, accounting for conversion delays, and applying learnings to next season.

What's changing this Holiday season



For years, shoppers searched for products. Now they're asking AI what to buy.



Holiday shoppers aren't just searching — they're asking, comparing, validating, and deciding within AI-powered experiences.



Brands that are easy to find are no longer enough. Brands must now be easy for AI to discover, understand, recommend, and trust.

The three eras of holiday shopping

Discovery is shifting from browsing, to asking, to acting — and AI readiness is the thread.

1

The human web

Shoppers browse and search. People find products by typing queries and clicking through results.

2

The LLM web

Shoppers ask. People turn to AI assistants like Copilot to compare, summarize, and get recommendations.

3

The agentic web

AI acts. Assistants increasingly find, evaluate, and complete purchases on the shopper's behalf.

To be discovered, recommended, and chosen, your brand must be easy to access and understand for both humans and AI..

The four phases of Holiday

Phase 01: **Wrap the basics – Foundation readiness**

Product feeds, measurement, and bidding foundations

Phase 02: **Gift them a reason – Demand creation**

Create consideration early

Phase 03: **Ring in the sales – Peak capture**

Capture the holiday moment

Phase 04: **Unbox what's next – Measurement & learning**

Measure results, uncover learnings, pivot messaging, capture post-holiday demand and maximize post-holiday opportunities.

Phase 01: Wrap the basics



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Phase 01

Wrap the basics & get setup for success – **Foundation readiness**

A strong holiday strategy starts with the right foundation

The fundamentals still win with:

1. AI readiness with **Microsoft Clarity**, an AI-ready product feed and **UCP** in Merchant Center);
2. **Well-structured media mix** with the optimal campaign portfolio;
3. **Up-to-date, comprehensive product feeds and inventory**;
4. **Accurate tracking** and **Measurement** in place with Universal Event Tracking (**UET**) and **Merchant Center**, **conversion tracking, automated bidding**, and meaningful **conversion values**.

Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions

Phase 01: **Prep & planning**

Before demand peaks



"Black Friday is when holiday starts."

"Audiences will build themselves."

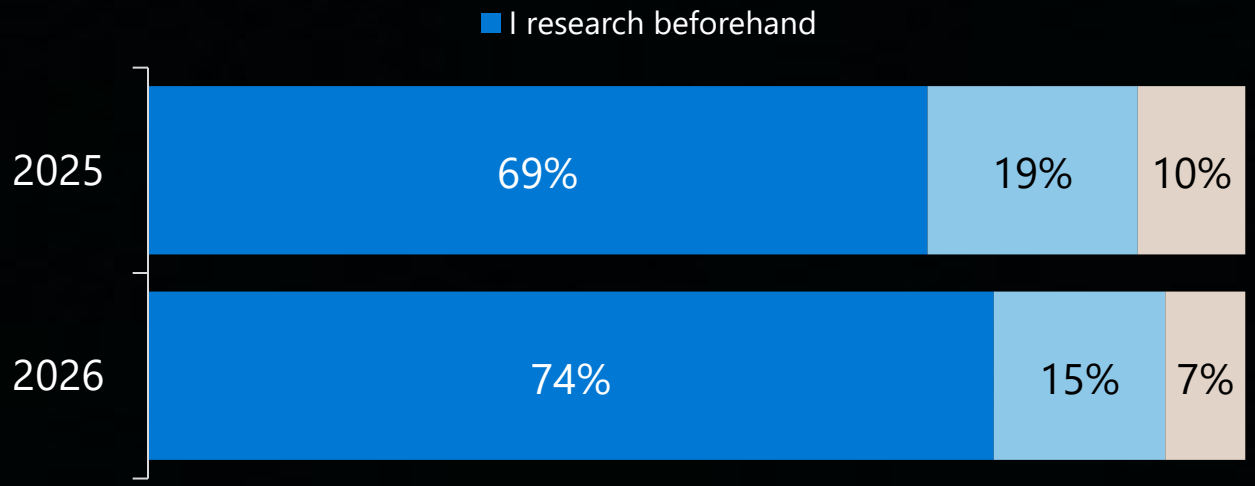
"We've already learned everything from last year."

- Consumer behavior, competition, and shopping trends evolve every season.
- Winning advertisers start building demand, audiences, and momentum weeks before peak shopping events.
- Success is built before Cyber Week through audience growth, testing, and campaign learning.
- Strong audience pools require early planning and accumulation.

Shoppers are planning earlier for major sales events

Nearly 3 in 4 shoppers now research products before Black Friday and/or Cyber Monday.

Approach to product research for key shopping events
Share of Respondents



Note: responses may not sum to 100% as the response "unsure" was removed.
Survey QQ: Which of the following statements best describes how you approach researching products for a shopping event, such as Black Friday or Cyber Monday?

Activate:

- Search
- Shopping Campaigns
- PMax
- Audience Ads

Before promotions are live to reach shoppers while you can still influence them.

Why AI readiness matters

The internet is the world's largest holiday shopping mall. AI is the personal shopper.

Winning this season depends on making it easy for AI to find, understand, trust, and recommend your products.



The fundamentals still win:

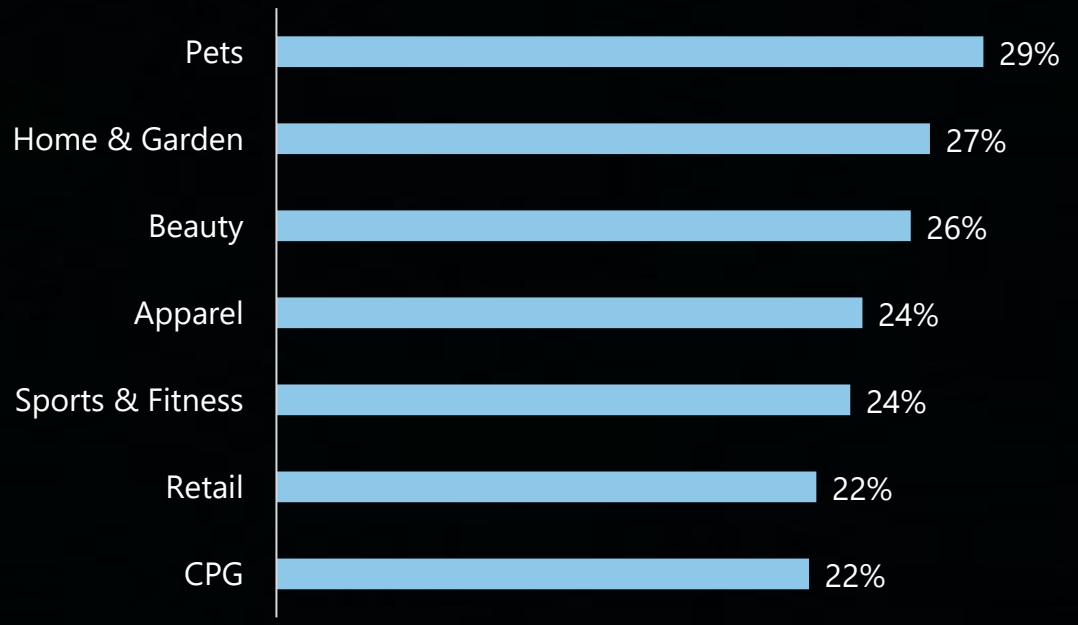
- strong measurement
- high-quality product data
- relevant creative
- effective campaigns

Now optimized for an AI-driven world.

Microsoft Retail & CPG audiences are more affluent

Our shoppers over-index on premium products

Microsoft vs. Google Premium Product Shoppers
(% higher index over Google)



GWI Shoppers (Last 6 Months) who use Microsoft Advertising vs. Google Advertising | 2025

Higher household income

Microsoft vs. Google Income

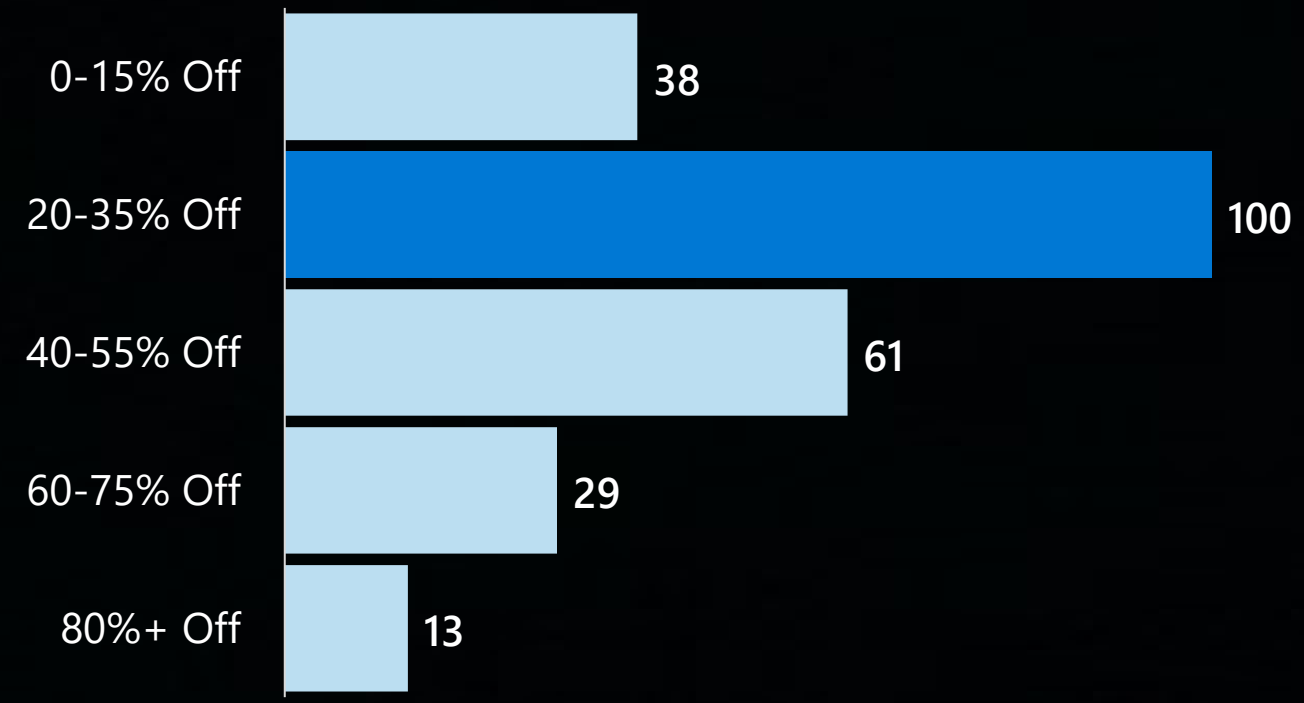
+12%

vs. Google Advertising shoppers

- Ensure **Merchant Center is up-to-date** to capture full product catalog.
- **Shift budgets** into Microsoft Advertising to better support your premium and/or higher consideration products.

Holiday shoppers are mostly searching for 20-35% offers

Q4 indexed search volume by offer



Tease offers early with:

- Audience ads

↓

Helps build awareness

Use:

- Merchant promotions

↓

Highlight available deals

Search and AI are converging

Search and AI are converging into more conversational, intent-rich customer journeys.

The average length of queries on Bing is up 11%.

As customers add context, AI understands intent better — creating opportunities for advertisers ready to be discovered, understood, and recommended across search and AI experiences.



AI readiness matters

JD Sports enters its next growth phase with an AI-ready strategy after **clicks jump 747%**



The results

747%
Click growth

99%
Brand core CVR

85%
Top impression share

Summary

- **The goal:** Prepare for AI-driven discovery during peak season
- **The solution:** Align campaigns with key business priorities
- **The strategy:** PMAX to capture cross-channel demand, Broad Match to expand relevant queries, and Auto-Bidding to react in real-time
- **The results:** Record revenue when demand was highest

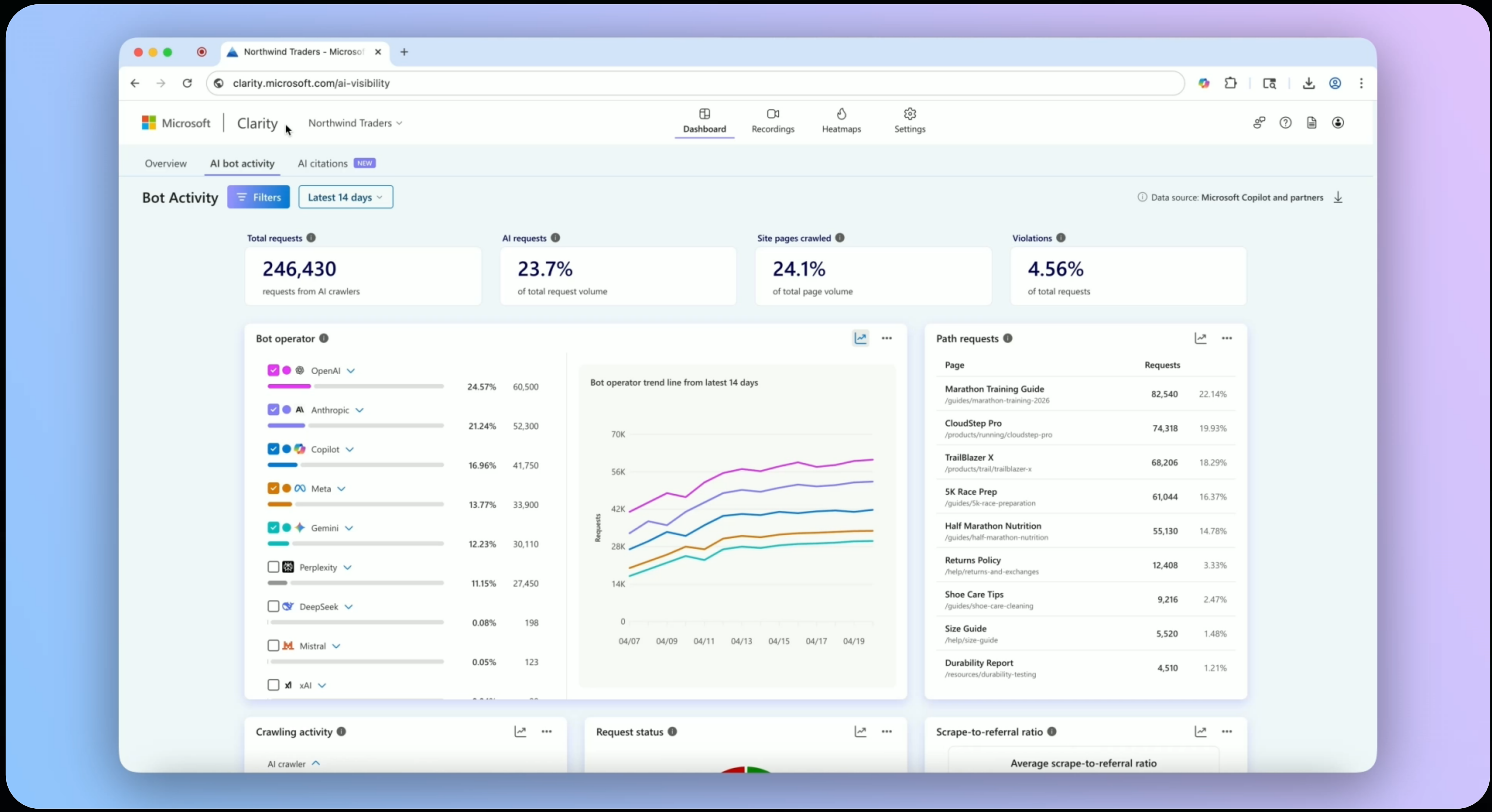
"We know that our customers are increasingly using AI-enabled experiences for inspiration. We want to show up for our customers where they are, so we launched a new AI-led structure ahead of peak. This gave the platform a fuller view of intent, turning inspiration moments into buying decisions."

Liza Nolan
Associate Director of Digital Media
JD Sports

Microsoft Clarity

Microsoft Clarity
from AI discovery to on-site conversion

- **Get discovered in AI**
  Clarity tracks how AI surfaces your brand
- **Know what to improve**
  Clarity recommends how to lift visibility.
- **Win after the click**
  Rage-clicks and drop-offs stay hidden.
  Clarity reveals on-site behavior to optimize.

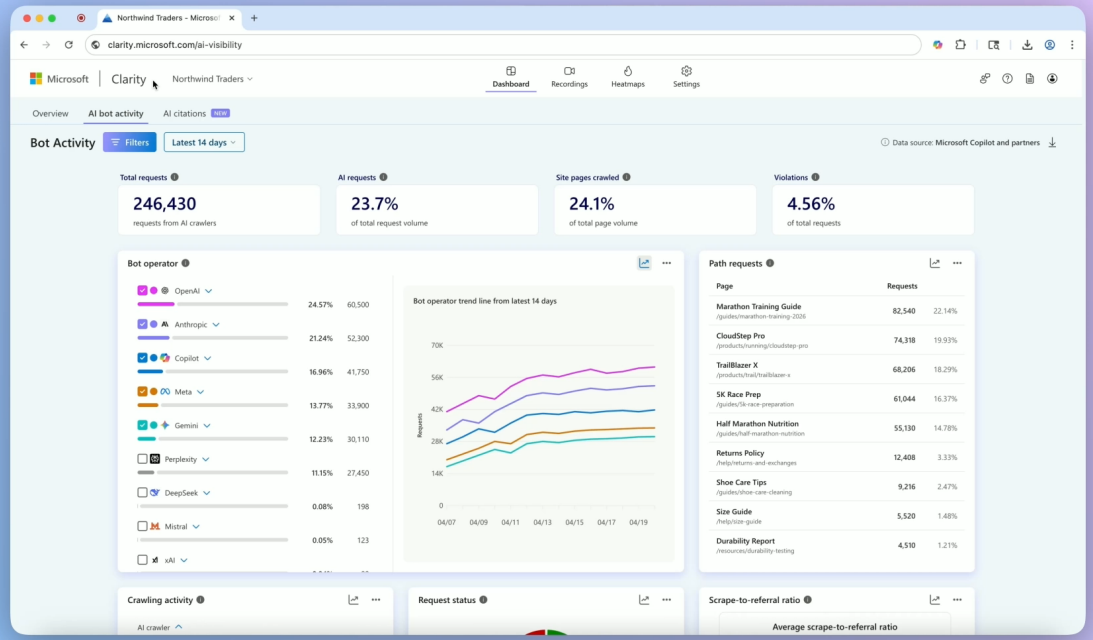


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PHASE 01 – TRACKING AND MEASUREMENT

Clarity AI visibility

Microsoft Clarity



Discovery: Bot activity

Track how AI crawlers and answer engines discover your site.

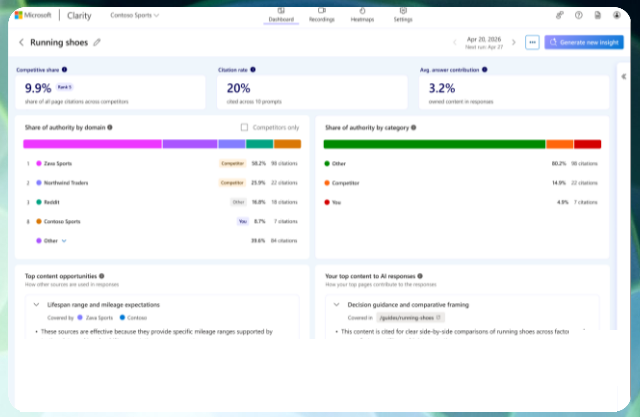
Visibility: Citations and share of authority

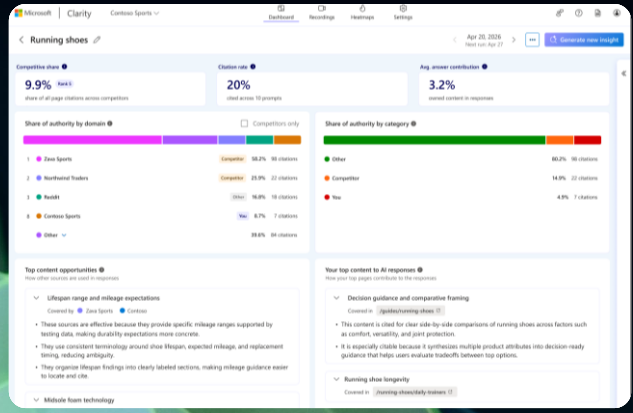
See where your brand appears in AI answers, which topics you show up for, and how you compare to your competitors.

Impact: Trends and outcomes

Track visibility trends over time and get content recommendations to improve AI selection and business outcomes.

	Query		SoA	Citations
1	northwind casual shoes	Branded	18.00%	7.00K
2	performance soccer shoes for athletes	Non-branded	20.50%	6.10K
3	walking shoes	Non-branded	19.00%	5.90K
4	professional tennis shoes for tournaments	Non-branded	27.50%	5.50K
5	northwind running shoes	Branded	30.00%	4.80K
6	northwind crossfit shoes	Branded	32.00%	4.50K
7	northwind slip-on shoes	Branded	17.50%	4.30K





BEHAVIOR ANALYTICS

See what happens after they land

Whether traffic comes from AI, search, or ads.

Session recordings

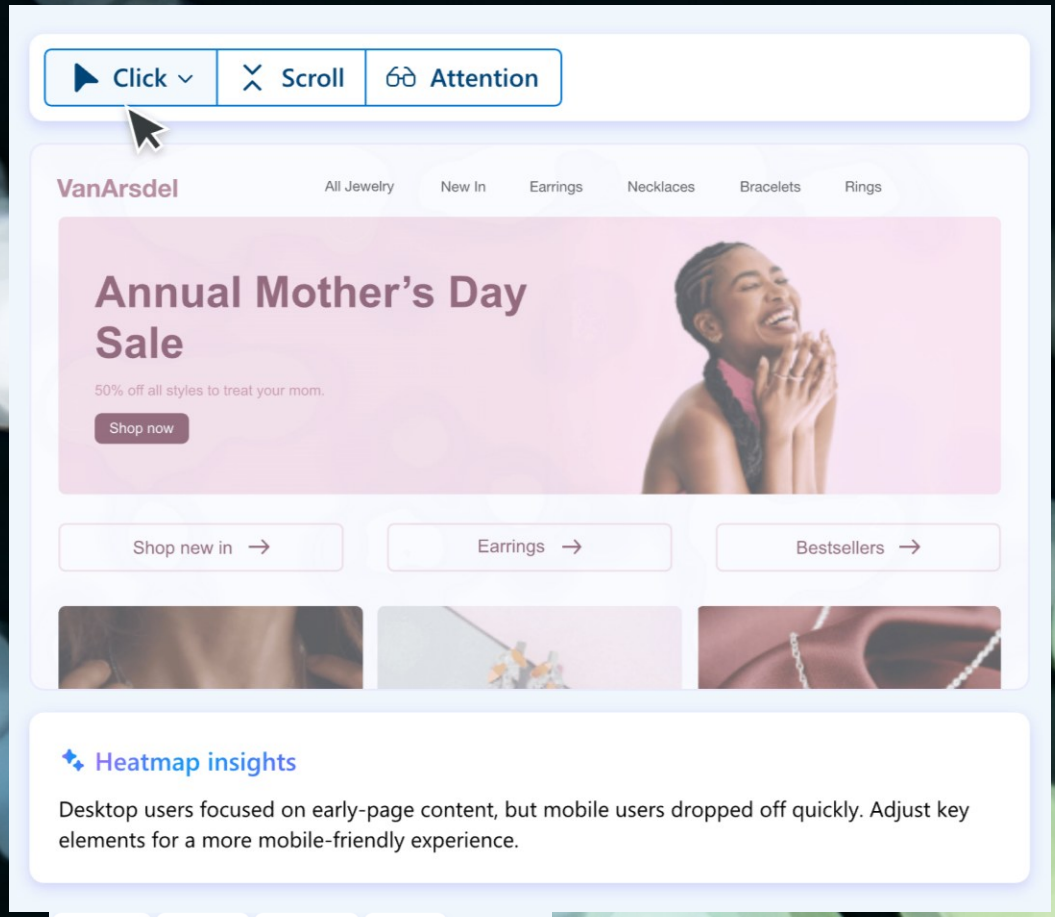
Watch real visits with rage-click and dead-click flags

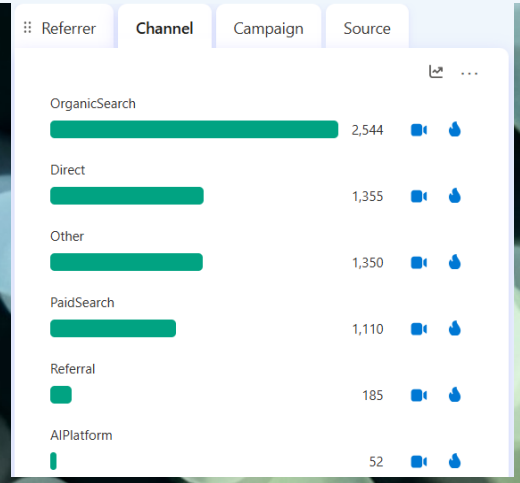
Heatmaps

See where attention goes and where it drops off

Smart Events

Auto-detect signups, purchases, downloads, and errors





Microsoft Clarity

Classified as Microsoft Confidential

Product feeds

AI readiness in Merchant Center

Make your products discoverable.
Richer product details help improve Copilot answers and drive greater engagement.

Provide your entire catalog

Do this:
Upload 100% of your catalog so your product can be discoverable in Copilot shopping and organic experiences.

Set up UCP in Merchant Center (Universal Commerce Protocol)

Do this:
1. In Merchant Center > UCP settings: Input your return policy and customer support contact info.
2. Update your feed to be AI-ready and support UCP.

Update your product feed to be AI-ready and support UCP

Do this:
native_commerce *(Copilot checkout)*
merchant_item_id *(unique ID tracks item across feeds and systems)*
consumer_notice_type and consumer_notice_message (consumer warning)
Add if regulatory compliance requirements apply

UCP is an industry standard language that lets AI assistants, platforms, and online stores work together to enable online shopping.

Best Practices: AI readiness for product feeds



Upload your entire catalog

Why it matters: AI can only surface products that are in your feed. Upload 100% of your catalog so every product can be discoverable in Copilot shopping — a partial feed leaves the rest invisible.



Complete, accurate product data

Provide titles, descriptions, GTIN/MPN, brand, and category for every item. Rich attributes improve matching and relevance.



High-quality images

Use clear, high-resolution images that meet image requirements. Avoid watermarks, promotional text, and placeholders.



Accurate price & availability

Keep price and stock in lockstep with your storefront. Mismatches are a leading cause of product disapprovals.



Automate feed refreshes

Schedule frequent, automatic feed updates so listings stay current as inventory and pricing change.



Monitor health & fix issues

Review diagnostics regularly, resolve disapprovals quickly, and act on optimization opportunities.

Making a list, checking it twice: Product feed audit checklist



THE BASICS

Ensure the foundation is in place.

- ☐ **Upload your entire product catalog for AI readiness** so products are discoverable in Copilot shopping.
- ☐ **Required fields** are complete
- ☐ **No duplicate titles**
  Differentiate titles for variant offerings with the color, size, materials, etc.
- ☐ **GTIN/MPN** is valid
- ☐ **Pricing** is correct and up to date
- ☐ **Product page URLs** correct and work
- ☐ **All products** are included in feed
- ☐ **Image URL** should be accessible and have a good image of your product
- ☐ Use **custom labels** to tag holiday hero products, best sellers, and strategic inventory



THE OPPORTUNITIES

More details in feeds is better.

- ☐ **Strong product titles**
  Create robust titles with product details.
- ☐ **Long product descriptions**
  Confirm accuracy and that they match landing page descriptions.
- ☐ **Recommended fields**
  Provide more metadata to help ads match to more relevant searches.
- ☐ **Product categorization**
  Clarify what your product is.
- ☐ **Routine updates to feed**
  Automate price and status updates.
- ☐ **Confirm feed parity with Google**
  Get the same products. Import can help.
- ☐ **UCP attributes**
  Add return policy, customer support

Top driver:
Optimize product title

"I don't show for 'small gift for a coworker" → Travel sized lavender **hand cream**

Product title:

Make your Product Titles as robust a possible. Include brand details, key search terms, and product attributes:

Brand + Product Name + Product Type + Gender + Size + Color (if applicable)

Test the order of product attributes in your title to understand which will drive most relevant traffic.



Run Search Term Reports to see which queries are triggering Product ads

Don't:

Put seasonal marketing messages in the product title.*

*unless the product itself is specifically a gift item. Ie. *Thanksgiving gift basket, Christmas ornament, etc.*

Top driver:
Optimize product description

"I don't show for 'small gift for a coworker" → Travel sized lavender **hand cream**

Product description:

- **Ensure descriptions are relevant, descriptive**, and include special callouts around holidays.
- **Include Microsoft Advertising key terms for both title and description** to help with product understanding and matching.
- **Add Holiday context** by highlighting seasonal uses cases:
  - Holiday entertaining, gifts for ___, or occasions (family gatherings).

Don't:

Insert keywords into every product description:

- "Great Christmas Gift" or "Best Black Friday Sale"

Forget to adjust product descriptions post-holiday season.

Product description should match with landing page product details and features.

Top driver:
Optimize product titles & descriptions for holiday

"I don't show for 'small gift for a coworker"



Good:

Travel sized lavender **hand cream**

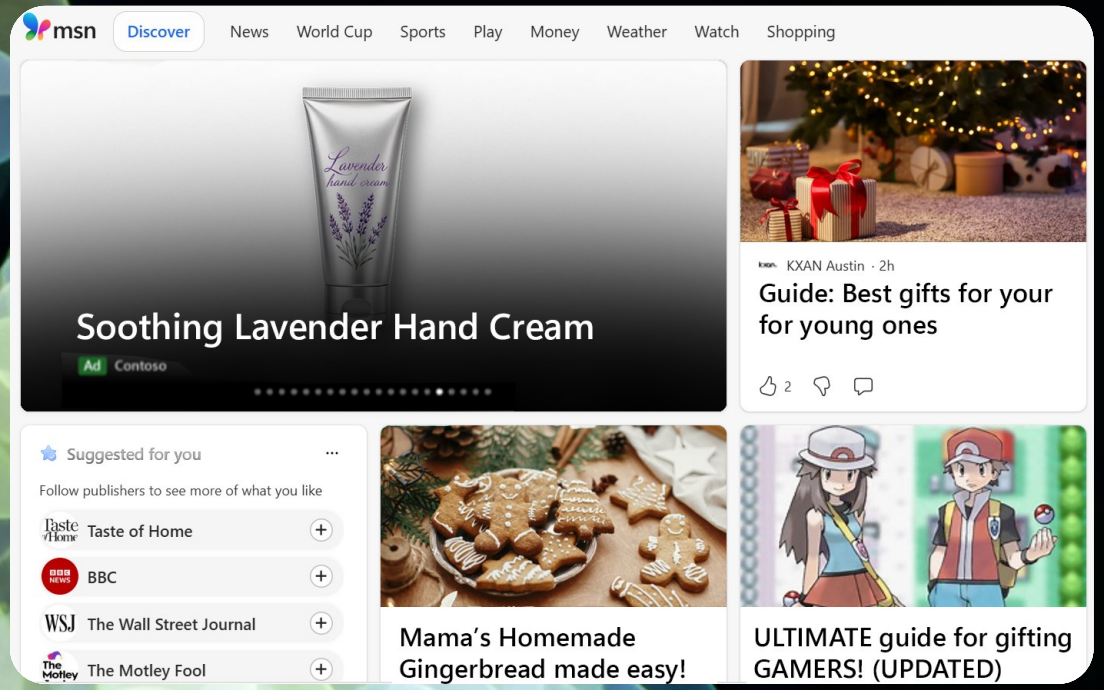
Enriched with **shea butter** and **lavender essential oil**, this smooth, **light-textured cream** gently helps to nourish the hands leaving them softly perfumed.

Better for holidays:

2.6 oz lavender shea butter **hand cream**

Enriched with **shea butter** and **lavender essential oil**, this **lightweight hand cream** helps nourish hands and leave them softly perfumed. At **2.6 oz**, it's ideal as a **small gift for a coworker**, and it provides the nourishment needed during the **wintertime.**

Expand your feed to Display and Native placements



Use your existing feed from search and expand into display and native.

When combined with Microsoft AI intent signals, we'll match users with the items in your feed that they've shown interest in.

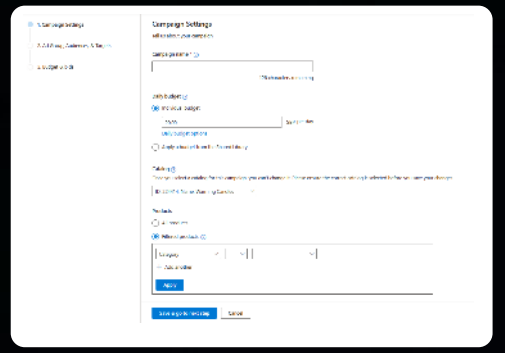
Set up your feed-based campaign

Four easy steps to set up, campaign creation in two minutes or less!

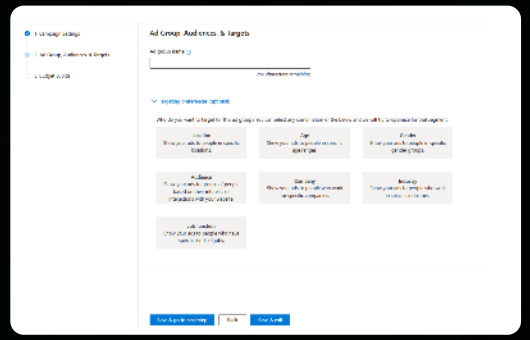
1. Create New Campaign and select 'Sell Products" as your campaign goal and "Audience" as your campaign type



2. Set Campaign Name, choose store and select 'All Products' filter. We recommend no product filters to maximize volume.

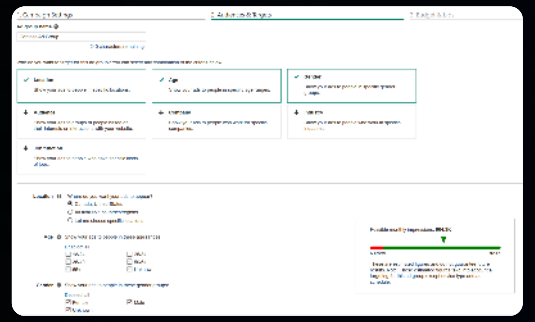


3. Choose your audience and targeting.



4. Set Daily Budget and Default Bid.

We recommend ~10% of Search shopping spend as a starting point and a minimum of $2.00 bid to start.



IMPORTANT TIPS TO REMEMBER

- Must have an active shopping feed to launch.
- UET is highly recommended, but not required.
- Allow 24-48 hours for delivery to begin ramping.

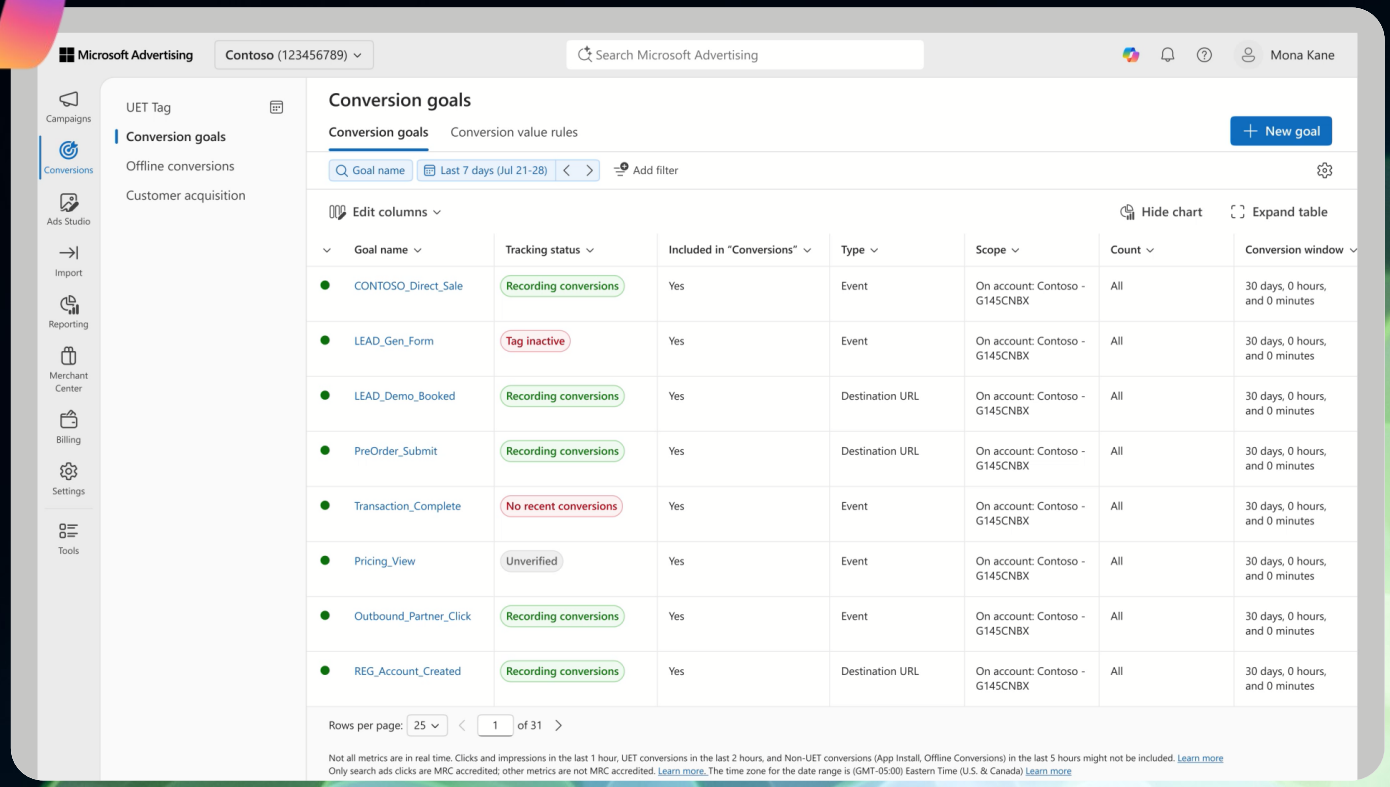
AI & measurement

Validate your measurement foundation

Audit UET implementation monthly and after major site updates. Incomplete or misfiring tags limit optimization.

Validate tracking end-to-end from click through conversion reporting.

- Copilot in MAP: Use a prompt like: ***Test my '[Conversion Goal Name]' goal and confirm if UET is configured correctly on my site.***
- Use **Test This Goal** feature on conversion goal grid



Maximize coverage across Microsoft Advertising

Different campaign types serve different objectives.



Most advertisers benefit from multiple solutions working together.



Media mix strategy

Define the right campaign mix

Standard Search
EXACT-MATCH CONTROL

Target exact match keywords to hold tight control over your highest-value, high-intent queries.

Audience ads
CREATE AWARENESS & CONSIDERATION

Capture mid-to-upper funnel demand and nurture towards conversion.

Performance Max
MORE CONVERSIONS ACROSS CHANNELS

AI that maximizes performance across Microsoft's full ecosystem.

Customization ⟷ **AI-powered optimization**

Standard Shopping
PRECISION & CONTROL

A catalog catch-all — or product-level control where you need it.

AI Max
SEARCH THAT SCALES TO NEW INTENT

Lifts Search performance, widens query coverage, and captures high-intent demand.

Build structures that support learning

Consolidate fragmented campaigns when volume is limited — a campaign with fewer than 30 conversions in 30 days is a candidate for consolidation.

→

Reserve **Exact Match** for critical coverage of **must-have search terms.**

↓

Use **AI Max and Performance Max** to **capture new demand** across Search, Copilot, and other surfaces.

←

Consider **portfolio bid strategies** for groups of campaigns with similar intent and margins.

How different campaigns interact with each other

Ad delivery for Search campaigns using exact match keywords is prioritized over Performance Max and AI Max campaigns. For all other campaign types, the campaign with the highest ad rank will serve.

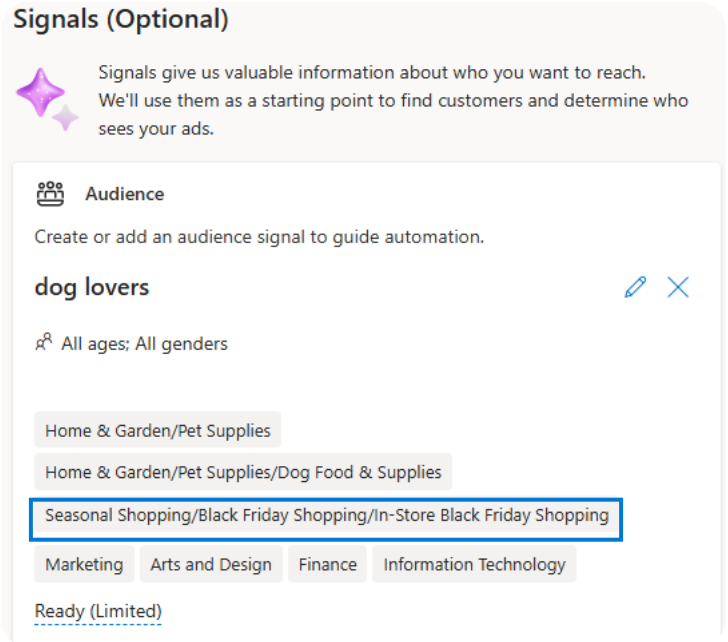
Campaign #1	Campaign #2
Performance Max campaign	Standard Search campaign – Exact match keywords
Performance Max campaign	Standard Search campaign – non-exact match (broad, phrase)
Performance Max campaign	AI Max – keywordless matching
Performance Max campaign	Audience campaign
Performance Max campaign	Standard Shopping campaign

Results

Exact match is prioritized over Performance Max

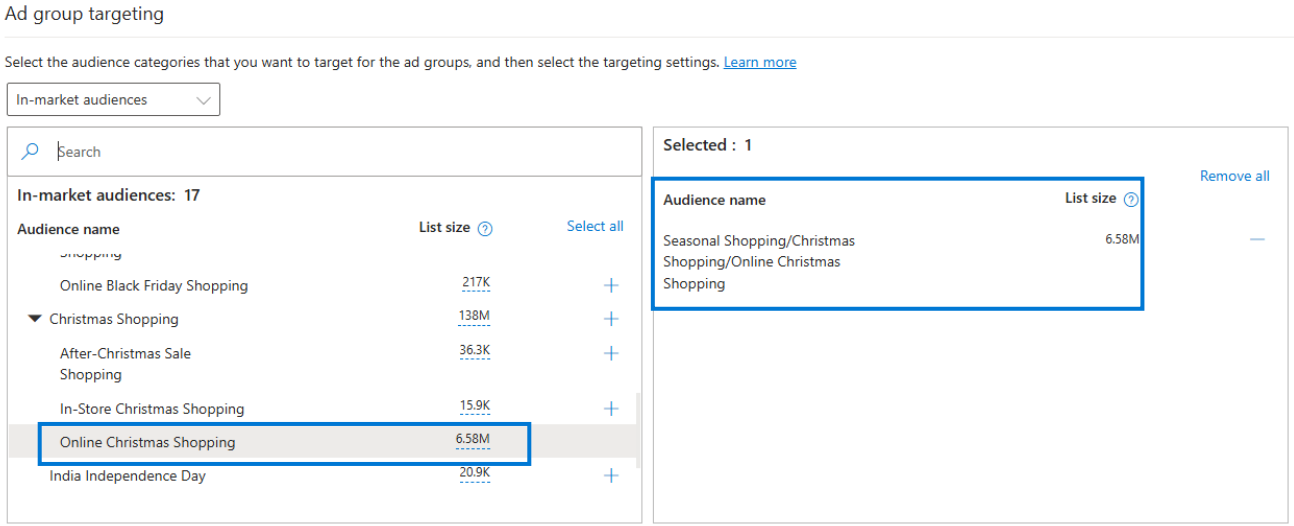
Ad rank determines which campaign enters the auction (*no CPC impact*)

Using Performance Max and Audience ads together



PMax campaigns provide broader, more automated reach and focus more on **bottom-funnel users** who are ready to convert.

Audience ads are better suited to advertisers who want a more targeted campaign and have goals at **upper points of the funnel**, not just conversion focused.

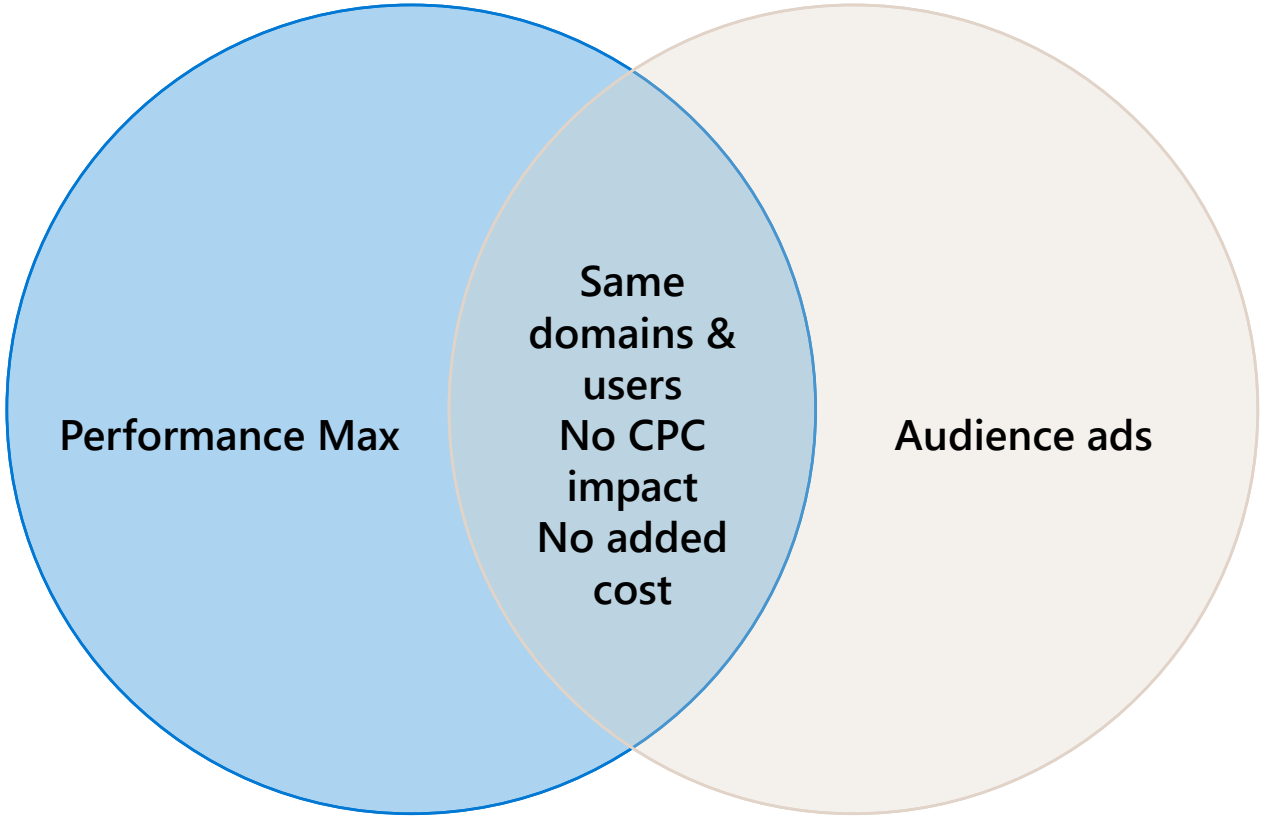


Media mix strategy

Using Performance Max and Audience ads together

No risk of cannibalization or inflating CPC between PMax and Audience ads

- **No CPC impact** across accounts, even when both campaigns target the same domain.
- **Audience overlap:** If campaigns share identical goals, they may pursue the same users with no impact on CPCs or cost.



Use Audience ads impression-based remarketing list as an audience signal on your PMax campaign.

Shared targeting overlaps the same users and domains, but the two campaign types never compete or raise CPCs.

Using Performance Max and Audience ads together

Better together

When using both campaigns together you should:

- ✓ Tailor messaging
- ✓ Keep PMax always-on
- ✓ Leverage creative insights
- ✓ Set appropriate CPA/ROAS goals



Top tip!

Set up an 'always on' Audience ads campaign that fuels your impression-based remarketing list.

Use this impression-based remarketing list as an audience signal on your PMax campaign.

AI Max or PMax?

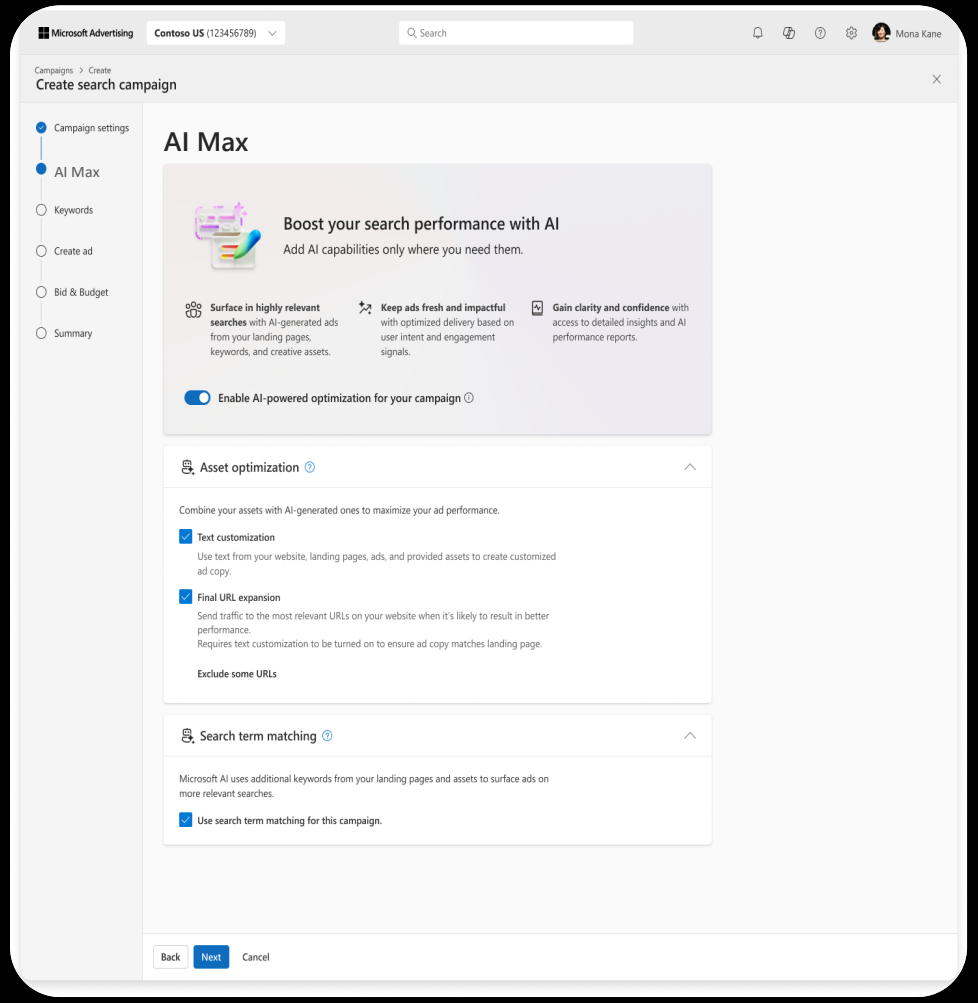
AI Max enhances Search with a balance of control and automation;
Use **PMax** for **maximum** reach and **automation** across every channel.

01 AI Max

Adds **automation to standard Search** and augment Search campaigns: it expands AI matching, personalizes creative, etc. with the control and transparency of Search.

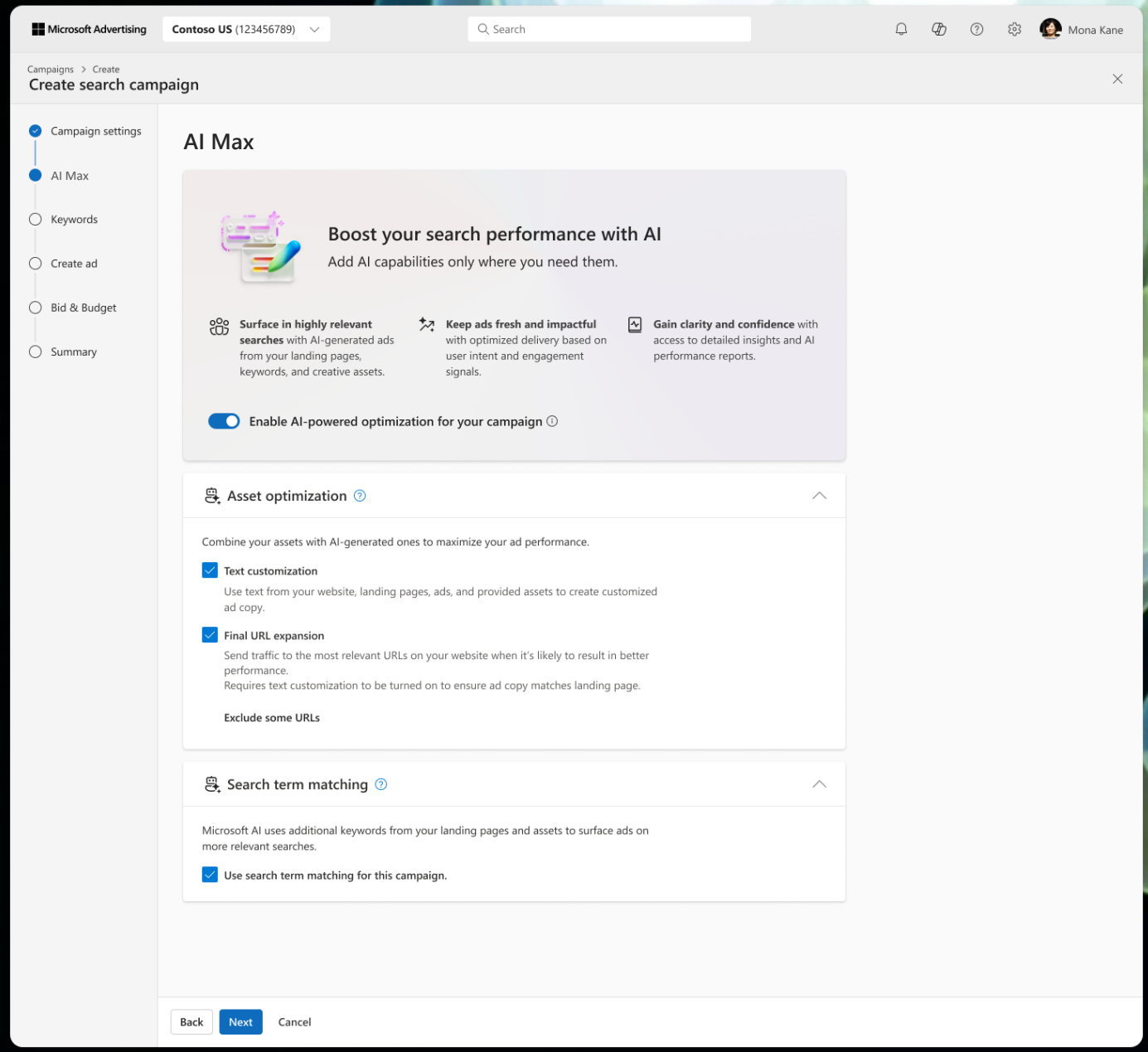
02 Performance Max

A separate **cross-channel campaign** type built to maximize reach and automation **across all of Microsoft's channels**, trading some control for **full automation.**



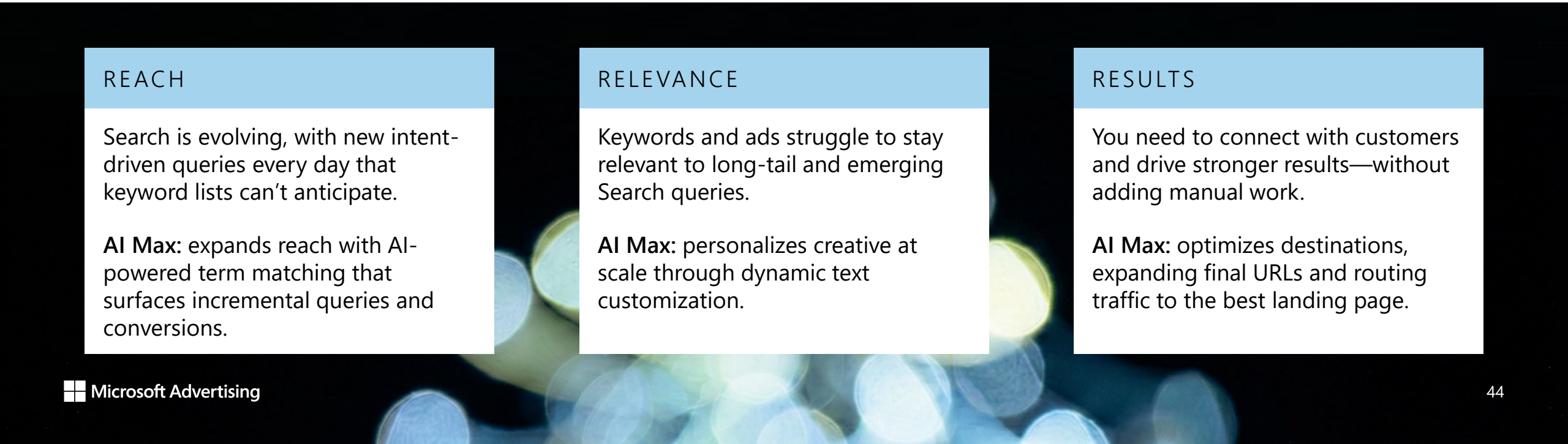
AI Max overview

AI Max is an **optional** Search campaign feature that uses the best of Microsoft AI to dynamically match ads to relevant searches by using advertiser-provided content and real-time signals.



AI Max:
Why now & what you gain

Helping you **stay ahead of the curve** — why AI Max matters now and the gains it delivers.



REACH

Search is evolving, with new intent-driven queries every day that keyword lists can't anticipate.

AI Max: expands reach with AI-powered term matching that surfaces incremental queries and conversions.

RELEVANCE

Keywords and ads struggle to stay relevant to long-tail and emerging Search queries.

AI Max: personalizes creative at scale through dynamic text customization.

RESULTS

You need to connect with customers and drive stronger results—without adding manual work.

AI Max: optimizes destinations, expanding final URLs and routing traffic to the best landing page.

Performance Max

Retail client campaign structure example

Structure by shopping network vs Search + Audience and then by brand and non-brand.
Shopping campaigns further broken by audiences. Search + Audience are broken by product type at asset group level
At least 30 conversions in 30 days.

	Shopping only PMax campaigns (no image assets) Nonbrand campaign utilizing Brand Exclusions		Search + Audience PMax campaigns (no feed, with image assets) Nonbrand campaign utilizing Brand Exclusions	
Campaign	pmax.nonbranded. shopping	pmax.branded. shopping	pmax.nonbranded. search	pmax.branded. search
Asset Groups	Product page	Product page	XPedition	XPedition
	Cart Abandoner	Cart Abandoner	Trike	Trike
	Website Visitor	Website Visitor	XPress	XPress
			XPeak	XPeak
			Lite	Lite

Easy to advanced campaign approaches – PMax for Retail example

EASY
One campaign

PMax campaign



Easy to setup and maintain
No control

MEDIUM
Separate Shopping

Search, Audience, etc.	Shopping
PMax assets ▪ No Merchant Center ▪ All other assets	**PMax products** ▪ Merchant center only ▪ No other assets ▪ No Final URL expansion

OR **Product segment A**
Product segment B

More control
Still fully relying on PMax algorithm

ADVANCED
Hybrid

Search, Audience, etc.	Shopping
PMax assets ▪ No Merchant Center ▪ All other assets **OR** Search ads exact keywords	**PMax products** ▪ Merchant Center only ▪ No other assets ▪ No Final URL expansion **OR** **Product segment A** **Product segment B** Standard Shopping "catch all"

Most control w/ the benefits of PMax
More complicated setup & maintenance

AUTOMATION ⟷ CUSTOMIZATION

Case study

Shopping powered by Microsoft Audience Signals

How it works

- Users who engage with an advertiser's products on their site, a reseller's website, or who have searched relevant keywords are identified and targeted via Microsoft first-party data signal.
- Ads are created utilizing existing Shopping feed components, just like Dynamic Remarketing.

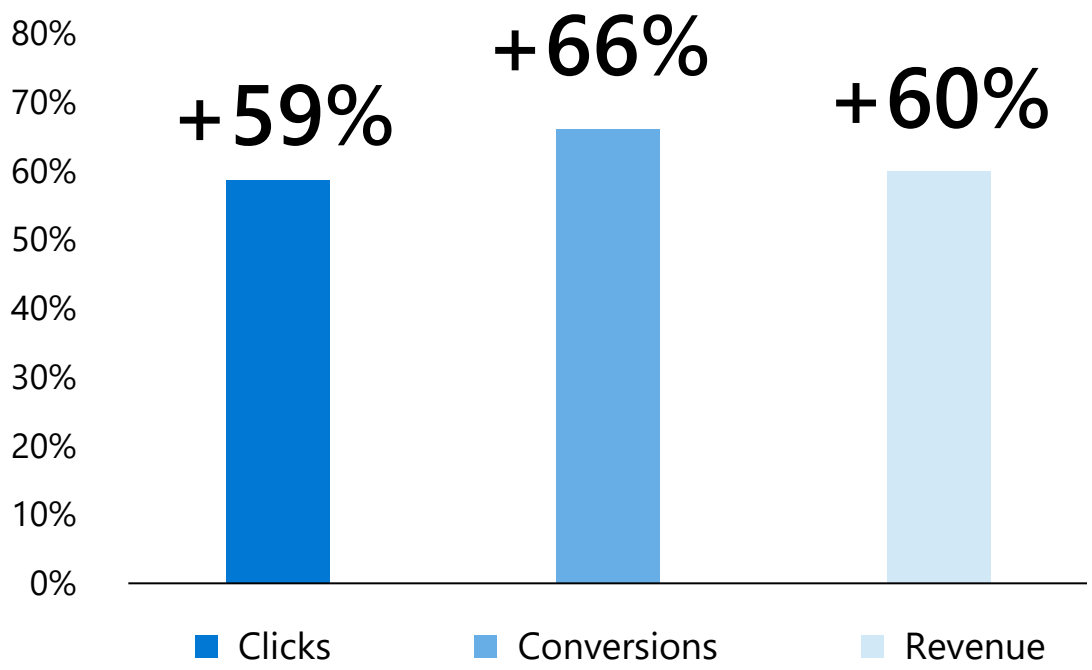
Benefits

- Minimal effort required—no need for extra ads, tag modifications or extra feeds.
- Allows you to recognise and target consumers who have expressed interest in your products not just on your own site, but also on reseller or competitor sites, even if they haven't visited your website directly.

1. Microsoft Internal Case Study Data–Apparel client–May–September 2023. Microsoft Audience Network Shopping ad performance compared to Search Shopping ad performance over the same period

For one Apparel advertiser, Shopping ads powered by Microsoft Audience Signals drove **$1.2M in incremental revenue**, at a ROAS **56% more efficient** than Search Shopping ads over the same period.

Results vs Search Shopping ads



Best practices to consider both in your prep and during peak days

1. Keep Automated Bidding strategies running as-is on key seasonal dates.
2. Ensure your campaigns are NOT limited by budget.
3. We don't recommend use of Max Cost Per Click (CPC) Caps.
4. Confirm Google Import settings if using the tool (one-time & recurring imports).



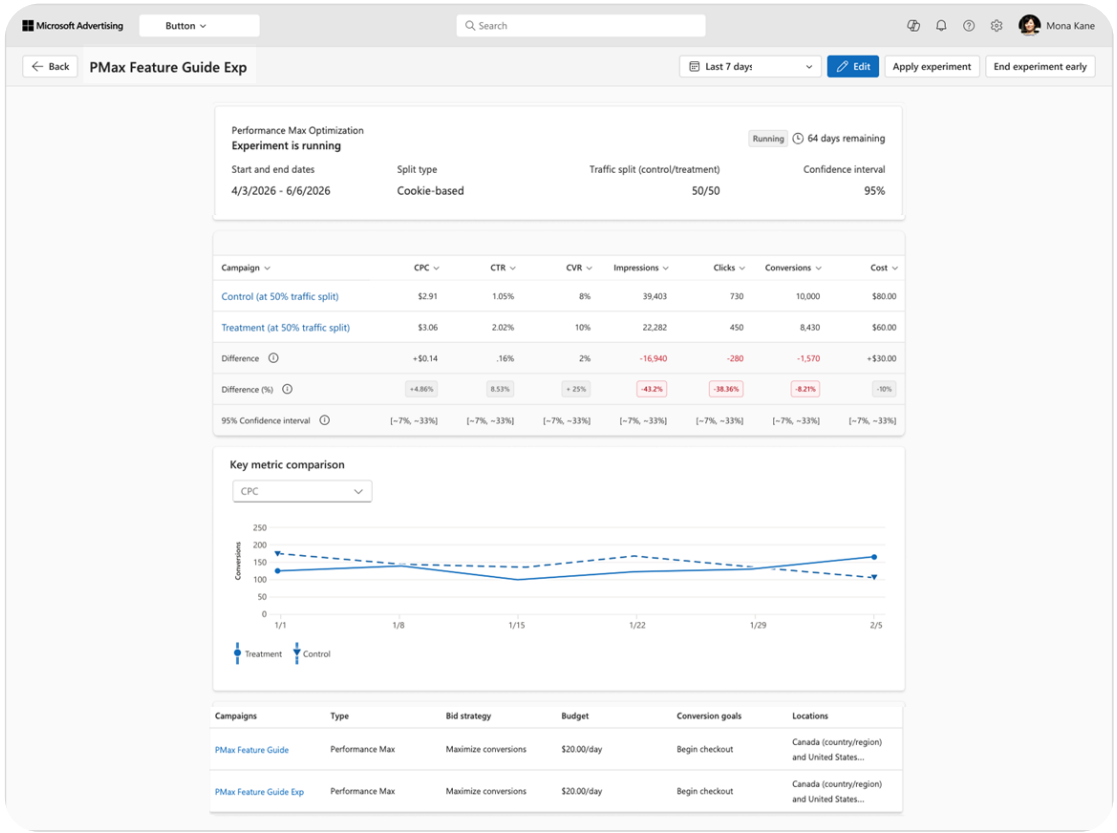
Measurement & bidding

Set up Automated Bidding, Seasonality Adjustments, Attribution models **before** peak periods

1. **Test early** and leverage **Campaign experiments** to try new bid strategies.
2. Ensure accuracy of your **Universal Event Tracking** (UET) tag and **Conversion Tracking** setup.
3. Start with **low-risk campaigns first**, if implementing a **new automated bidding strategy.**
4. Allow at least **four weeks** for new bidding strategies **to stabilize.** Sames goes for **new conversion** goals
5. Set up selected strategies early to **give time to collect ample data sets**.
6. Consider switching to **Data-driven** attribution model with **large conversion volume**.
7. Set up **Seasonality Adjustments** for campaigns with stable performance. If multiple adjustments on the same campaign, all apply, it works with experiments.

Experiments

Why optimization experiments?



Make evidence-based decisions

Use statistically significant results, not guesswork.

Minimize performance risk

Validate bidding, targeting, creative, and other campaign changes before scaling.

Act on results quickly

Apply winning experiments to your original or a new campaign in one click.

Classified as Microsoft Confidential

How to use Campaign Experiments for assessing the performance of a bid strategy

Set up

- Identify a campaign you'd like to test an automated bid strategy on.
- Create a campaign experiment from this campaign.
- Select 50/50 experiment split.

Test

- Keep all other variables the same (ads, keywords, targeting), just testing the bid strategy (A/B mode).
- Select an automated bid strategy for the experiment campaign.
- Run the experiment with no changes for at least a week for it to gather history (A/A mode).

Evaluate

- Run for at least 1-2 weeks before starting to evaluate performance as the campaigns will be in the learning period.
- Compare performance between campaigns post the initial learning period.
- Apply the desired change to the original campaign based on the experiment results. (experiment campaign automatically gets paused).

Classified as Microsoft Confidential

Optimization experiments best practices



Campaign selection

- Use high-volume campaigns, when possible, otherwise experiments may require longer experiment durations to reach statistical significance.
- Campaigns using shared or lifetime budgets are currently not supported.
- A campaign cannot participate in multiple experiments that will be active at the same time.



Traffic split

- Use a 50/50 traffic split to gather volume quickly and make comparisons easier.
- Experiment traffic split cannot be changed once an experiment is running.
- Results are automatically normalized so you can compare treatment (clicks, conversions, conversion value, cost, and impressions) and control fairly.



Experiment launch

- Test only one variable at a time.
- Switch to A/B mode for at least 2 weeks (ideally 4 weeks).

Measurement

Strengthen optimization signals

Stronger signals drive stronger optimization. Automated bidding learns fastest when it receives complete, high-quality data.

Strengthen these signals before holiday demand peaks so bidding can optimize with confidence.

Data sources provide signals that help systems learn faster, optimize more effectively, and drive better results.

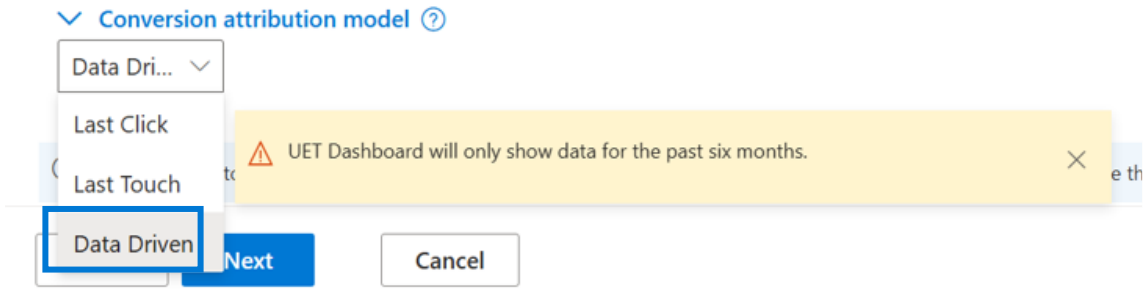
- **Connect first-party data sources** with the Conversions API across online, website, offline, CRM, and app systems before the holiday season.
- **Track high-intent, mid-funnel actions** to give bidding earlier signals on likely converters and accelerate learning. Use these as secondary goals for insight, while keeping primary optimization on your most important outcome, such as purchases.
- **Pass conversion values whenever possible.** Revenue value ensures you optimize for value, not just volume.

Data-driven attribution

Data-driven attribution helps bidding optimize toward the touchpoints that truly drive performance and reflect how customers convert across the full journey

Consider updating your attribution model from last-click to Data-driven.

- **Distribute credit across the full journey** — switch to Data-driven Attribution (DDA) so conversion credit reflects the entire path, not just the final interaction
- **Confirm eligibility** — available for campaigns running conversion-based bid strategies (including Enhanced CPC) with large conversion volume (200+ conversions in 30 days).

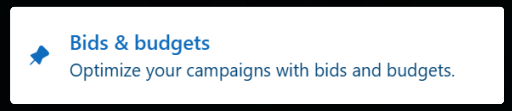


Set up & optimize seasonality adjustments

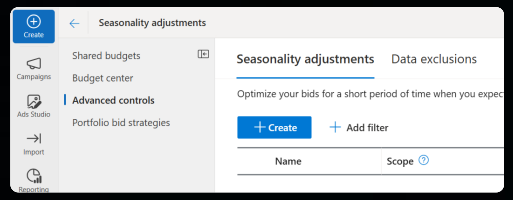
How to create

1. Go to Tools > Bids & Budgets
2. Open Advanced Controls > Seasonality Adjustments
3. Click Create to add a new adjustment
4. Enter a name (and optional description)
5. Set start and end time — range must be 14 days or less
6. Define scope and select devices
7. Define the conversion rate adjustment
8. Click Save to finalize

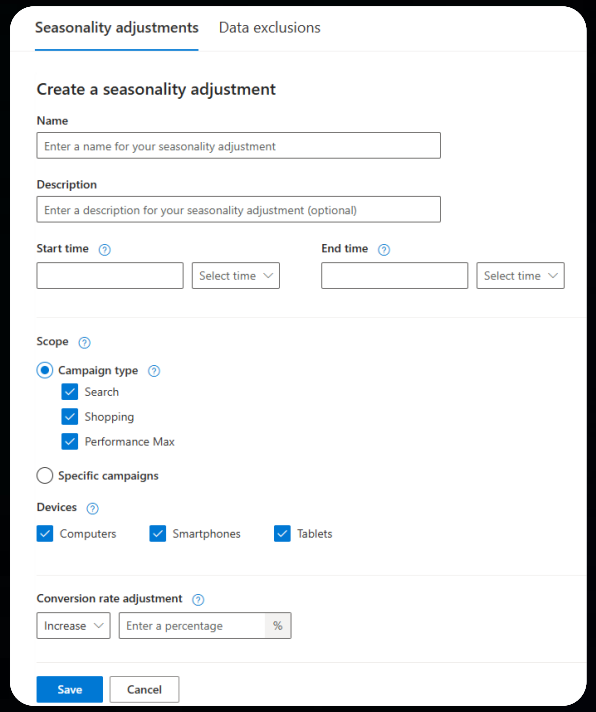
1



2



3



BEST PRACTICES

- Apply it to campaigns with stable performance with automated bidding and a completed learning period.
- Create multiple adjustments targeting various campaigns or time periods; if several target the same campaign, all are applied.
- Can be applied to campaign experiments if both experiment and original campaigns are targeted.

Best practices with seasonality adjustments

Campaigns using Seasonality adjustments will need to have stable performance with automated bidding and already completed their learning period.

Seasonality adjustments should not be used to address initial learning period fluctuation.

- You can create multiple adjustments targeting various campaigns or various time periods.
- If multiple adjustments target the same campaign, all adjustments will be applied.
- Seasonality adjustments can be applied to campaign experiments if both experiment and original campaigns are targeted.

USE CASES



- Preparing for peak travel times during holidays to capture increased demand for booking flights in the weeks leading up and help re-adjust the days after the holiday travel peak.
- Getting setup for success in the days leading up to, during, and right after cyber week (Black Friday, Cyber Monday, etc.).

Wrap the basics — foundation readiness checklist

Before demand builds, confirm the campaign, feed, measurement, and bidding fundamentals are ready for AI-assisted discovery and peak-season scale.

Campaign mix & structure

- ☐ Confirm the right mix across Search, Shopping, AI Max, PMax, and Audience ads.
- ☐ Consolidate low-volume campaigns or use portfolio strategies where learning is thin.
- ☐ Reserve Exact Match for must-have terms; use Broad Match, AI Max, and PMax for expansion.

Feeds & AI readiness

- ☐ Upload 100% of the catalog and complete UCP / Merchant Center settings.
- ☐ Enrich titles and descriptions with variant details, seasonal use cases, and valid IDs.
- ☐ Tag hero products, best sellers, promotions, and strategic inventory with custom labels.

Measurement & bidding

- ☐ Validate UET, conversion goals, attribution model, and conversion values end to end.
- ☐ Set up bidding experiments and seasonality adjustments early enough to learn.

Phase 02: Gift them a reason



Microsoft Advertising

Phase 02

Gift them a reason –
Demand creation

Create demand

1. Develop audience **strategies early**
2. Expand reach and **increase visibility ahead of peak** shopping moments
3. Set up **new customer acquisition** with PMax.
4. Connect with **untapped audiences** through:
    - **LinkedIn Profile Targeting**
    - **Seasonal in-market audiences**
    - **New customer acquisition** strategies
5. Influence shoppers earlier in their decision-making journey with **Impression-based remarketing**
6. Search themes **as additive signals for PMax**
7. **Optimize for seasonal relevance**
8. **Refresh creative** and promotional messaging to align with holiday trends
9. Adjust campaigns to **capitalize on seasonal demand shifts**
10. **Stay relevant** throughout the shopping season

Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions



Phase 02: **Engage during peak season**

Driving awareness, consideration, and customer engagement



"Search is enough."

"Creative doesn't matter during the holidays."

"We should focus only on existing customers."

- Shoppers engage across multiple channels before converting, **and AI Max, Performance Max, Shopping, and Audience Ads** help create, expand, and **capture demand** along the journey.
- **Seasonal messaging**, offers, and urgency can significantly impact performance.
- Holiday growth often attracts new shoppers earlier in the buying journey, making **upper-funnel engagement** a key driver of conversions before the final click.
- The holiday season is one of the biggest **opportunities** to acquire **new customers.**

The average Holiday conversion journey is

52 days

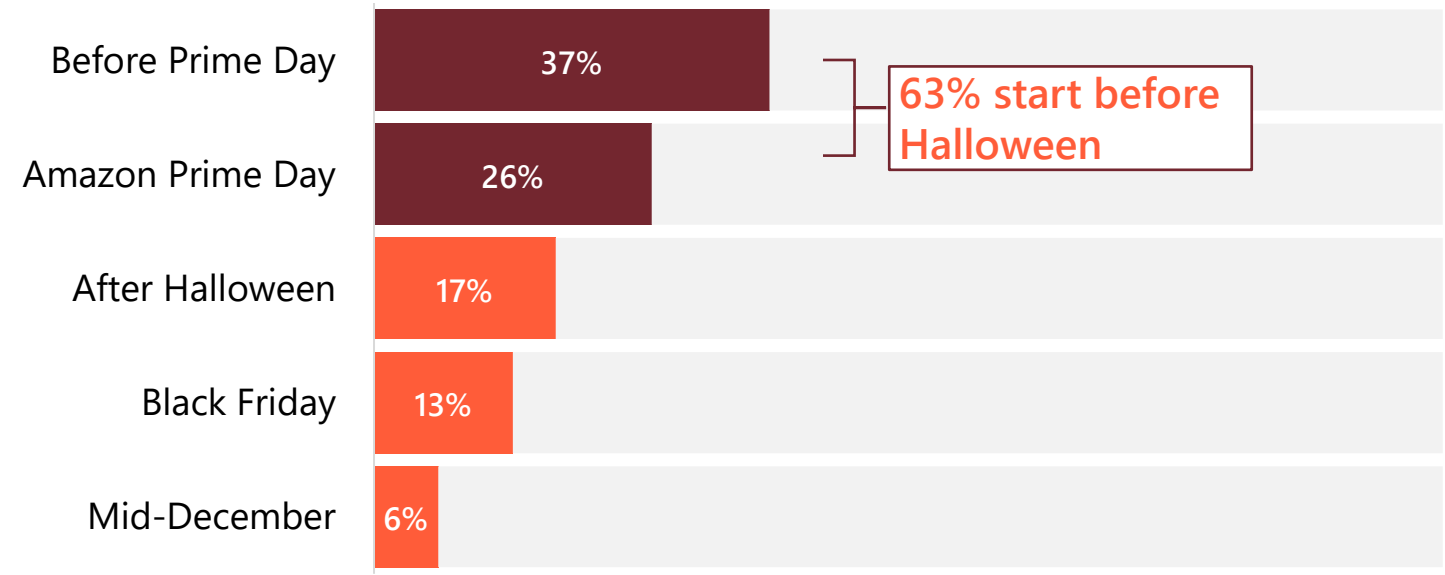
Strong visibility throughout the **full season** is critical to engaging and re-engaging holiday shoppers.

- ✓ Create awareness early with upper funnel Audience Ad tactics.
- ✓ Build and target robust remarketing lists to re-engage consumers, during and post Cyber-5.



Oct Prime Day starts holiday shopping for many consumers

When Holiday shoppers plan to start
Share of Respondents



Before October Prime Day have ready

- Holiday messaging
- Product feeds
- Budgets
- Full-funnel coverage

↓

to capture early demand

Microsoft 1P Survey | 15-min online study | n=1024 | US Only| Responses may not sum to 100% due to rounding.

Best practices to consider both in your prep and during peak days

1. Keep Automated Bidding strategies running as-is on key seasonal dates.
2. Ensure your campaigns are NOT limited by budget, which will cost you sales.
3. We don't recommend use of Max Cost Per Click (CPC) Caps.
4. Test Seasonal In Market Audience (Import from Google if available)
5. Review Google Import if using the tool (one-time & recurring imports settings).

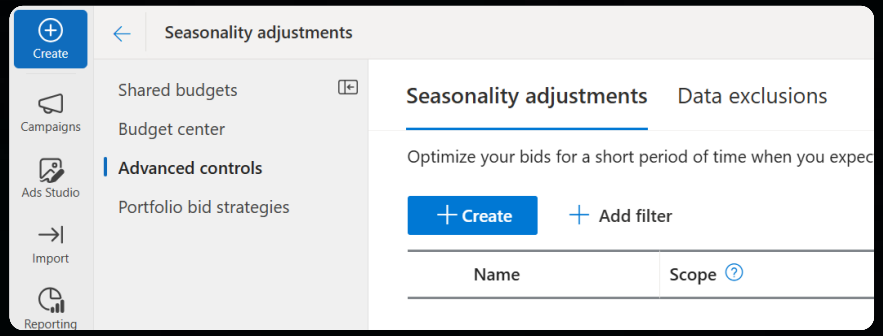
Key auto-bidding best practices

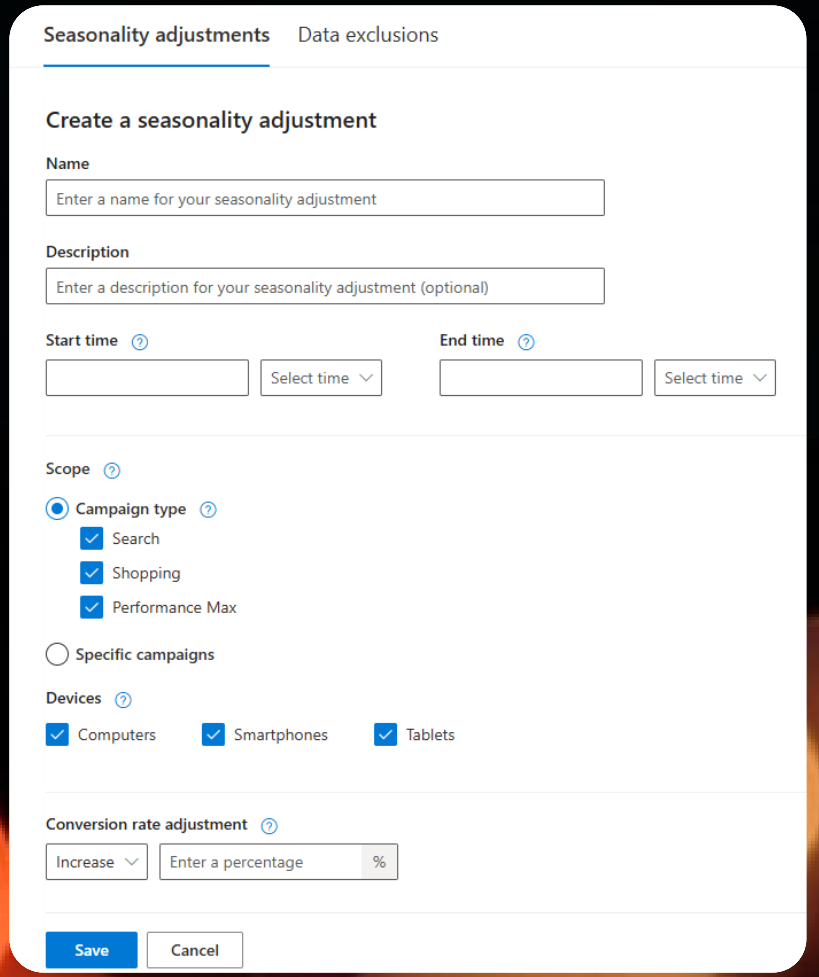
Common practice then	Our recommendation NOW
1 Start a **new campaign on eCPC**, then later transfer to auto-bidding when hit 30+ conversions in 30 days	If your overall account has >5 conversions, **start testing on Max Conv (w/ tCPA) or Max Conv. Value (w/ tROAS)** from the get-go. Ideally, still evaluate performance with 30+ accumulated conversions in 30 days.
2 **Add bid modifiers** to help guide the algorithm.	**Remove bid modifiers** for age, gender, device, location, and remarketing/dynamic remarketing audiences, the system takes those signals into account.
3 Change targets **only** once per conversion cycle at <15% increments, **as they trigger a learning period**.	**Targets can be changed at any time** to steer the campaign, **they do not trigger a learning period**). Exercise caution with extensive loosening of targets: because it's exploring new inventory, it might create some short-term volatility. With Microsoft Advertising, targets remain directional levers **even when budget constrained**.

Seasonality Adjustments for peak moments

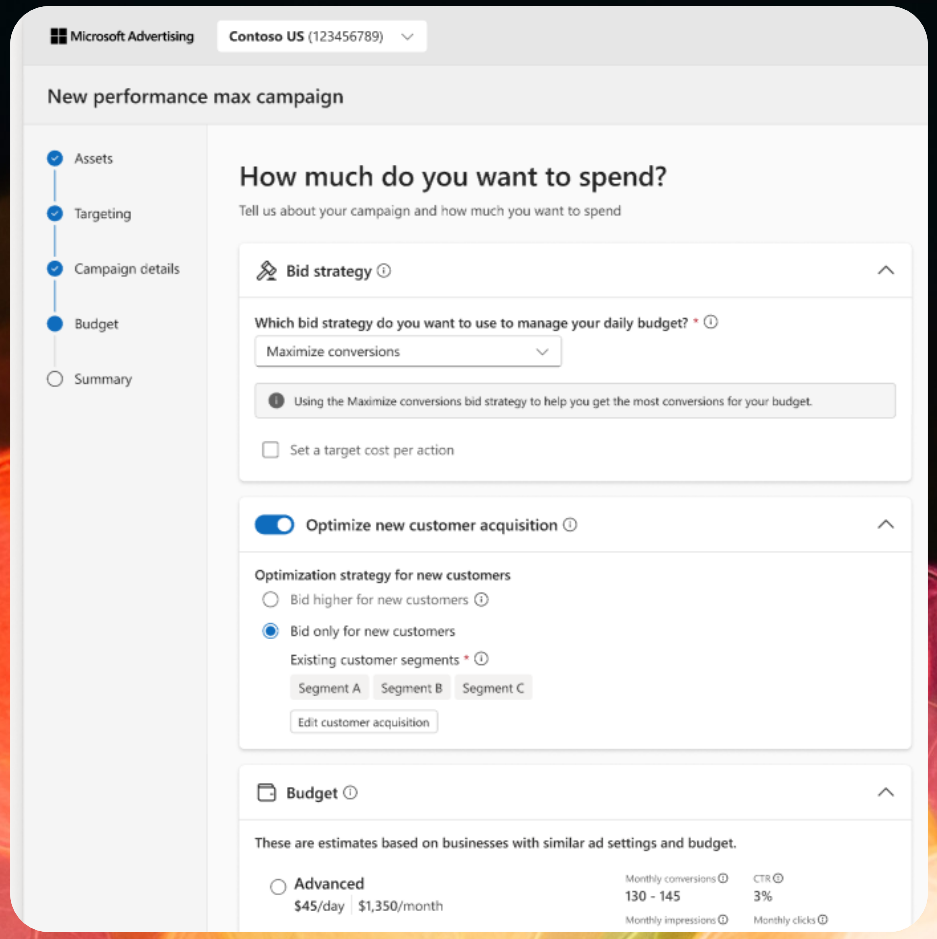
If you anticipate conversion rate changes, consider seasonality adjustments.

Get setup for success in the days leading up to, during, and right after cyber week (Black Friday, Cyber Monday, Christmas, etc.)





New Customer acquisition



BID UP FOR NEW CUSTOMERS ONLY, KEEP THE SAME FOR EXISTING CUSTOMERS

NEED TO KNOW / DO

- Set Maximize conversion value as your bid strategy.
- Target ROAS is optional.
- Create a Purchase conversion goal at the account level.

RECOMMEDED IF YOU WANT TO

- Maintain your scale and engagement with potential returning customers
- Have a higher conversion value set for new customers

TARGET AND BID **ONLY** FOR NEW CUSTOMERS

NEED TO KNOW / DO

- Optimize your bids to target new customers exclusively.
- The audience list will help us optimize for new customers during ad delivery, and is the list we are excluding.

RECOMMEDED IF YOU HAVE:

- Strict budgets or creative assets for new users vs. returning users
- Non-purchase conversion goals like lead generation.
- Another PMax campaign for all customers.

Performance Max

Optimize your campaign to target new customers on PMax

Option 1

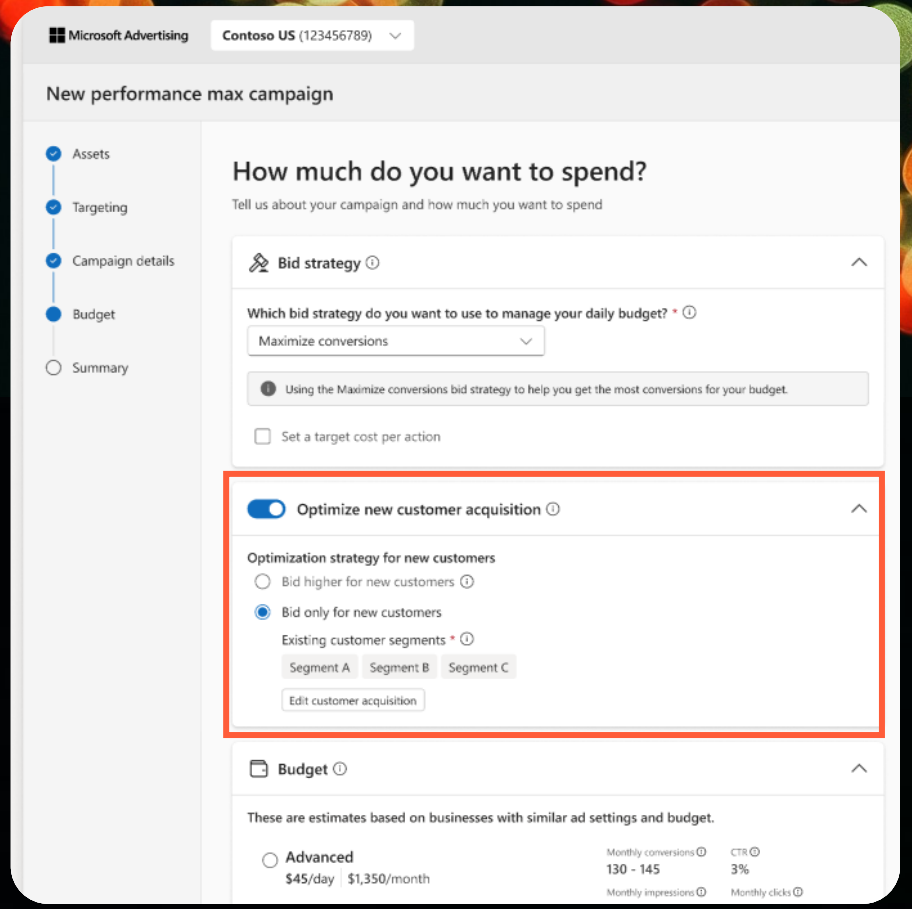
Increase bids for new customers: This increases your bids for new customers while continuing to bid for existing customers. If you choose this option, you must:

- Set Maximize conversion value as your bid strategy.
  - Target ROAS is optional.
- Create a Purchase conversion goal at the account level.

Option 2

Target and bid only for new customers: This optimizes your bids to target new customers exclusively.

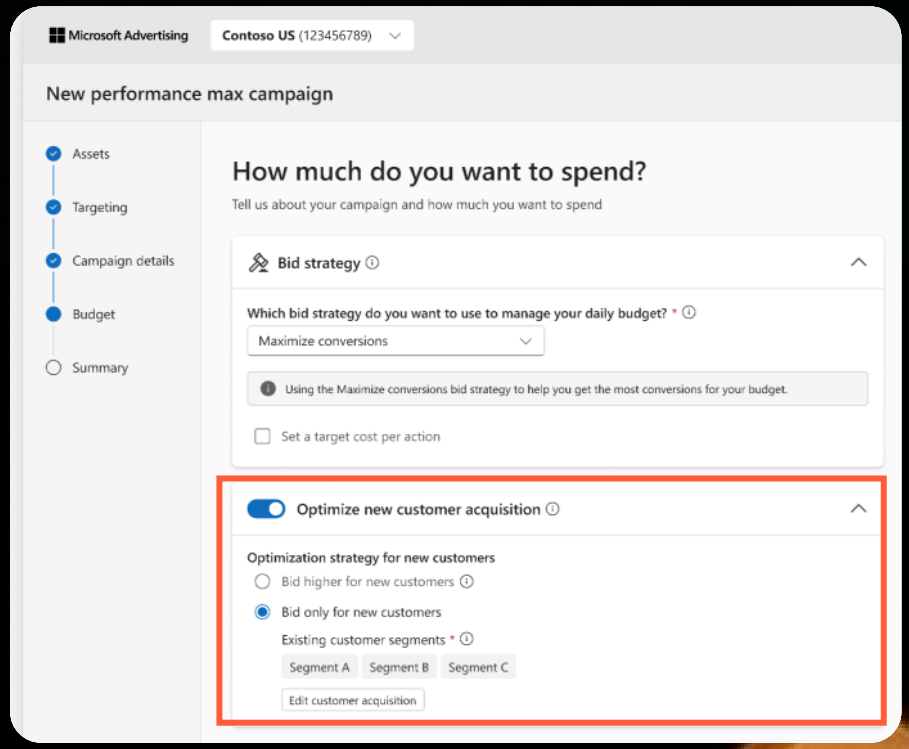
Your audience list will help us optimize for targeting only new customers during ad delivery.



Setup guide

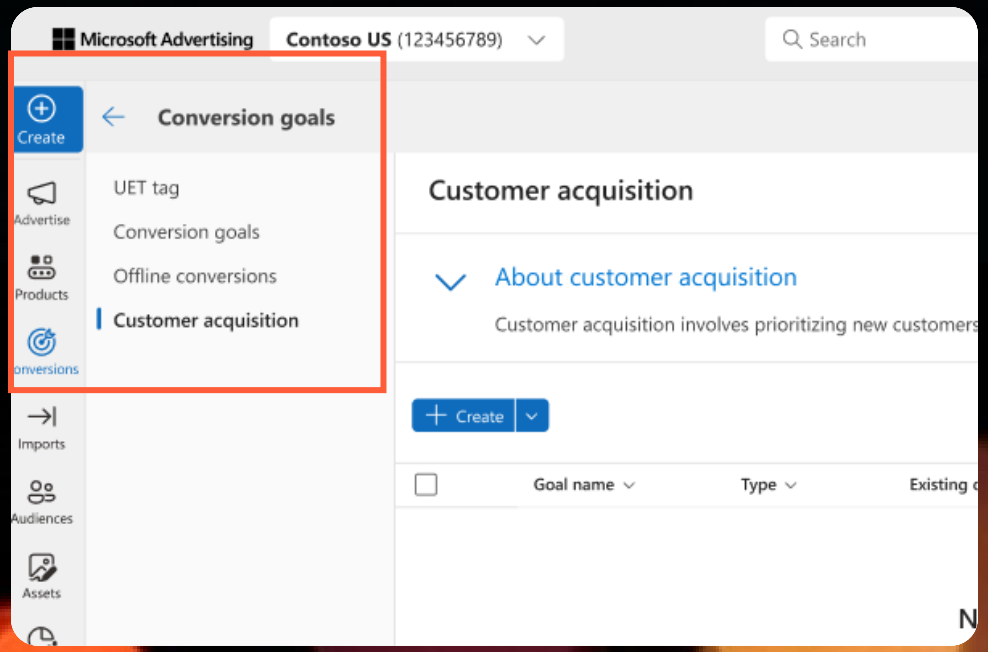
Option 1:

During Performance Max campaign creation/editing:



Option 2:

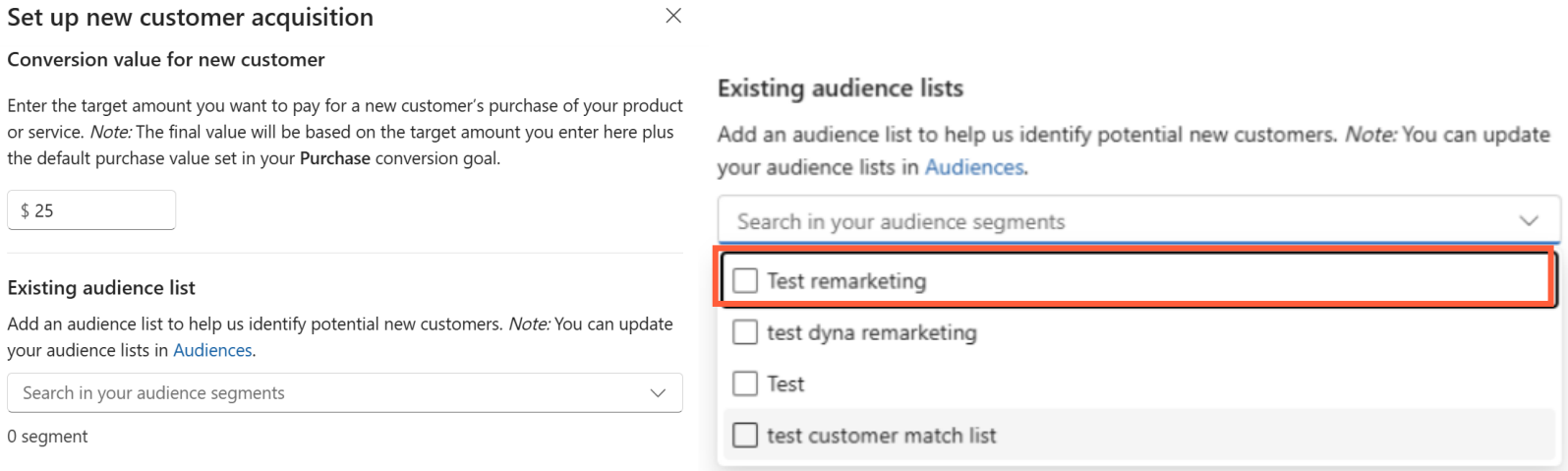
From the Conversion goals page:



Choosing the conversion value and your audience lists

1. Enter the Conversion value for new customers and optionally add an audience list.

   This will then be the audiences of existing customers that the campaign will **not** bid higher for or target

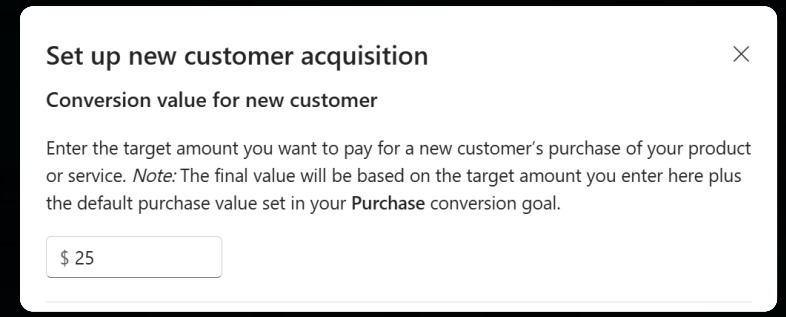


- If you choose Bid only for new customers, you must add at least one audience list.
- These audiences are lists you want to essentially EXCLUDE.
- Refresh audience lists often.

Best practices on setting a conversion value for new customer (only used for bidding up within current campaign)

Let's reflect: how much more valuable is a new customer vs. a returning one?

Pro Tip: ideally, setting an additional revenue value that's **at least 30% of the average revenue** you see from a usual sale is best to help the campaign optimize towards new customers.



Online printing company example:

01	AOV last 30 days: $167
02	30% of AOV: $50
03	Set my NCA value to $50 for new customers

Note: Even if it's an estimate, inputting a higher value will help signal the algorithm that you value new customers more than existing ones. **The final value will be based on the target you enter PLUS the default purchase value set in your conversion goal.**

Consider offering "first order promotions" in ad copy to entice new customers.

So which adventure do I choose?

Bid UP within my current campaign

Recommended if you want to:

- Prioritize bidding towards new customers
- Maintain your scale and engagement with potential returning customers
- Ensure you have a higher conversion value set for new customers

Setting up a separate NCA campaign

Recommended if you want to:

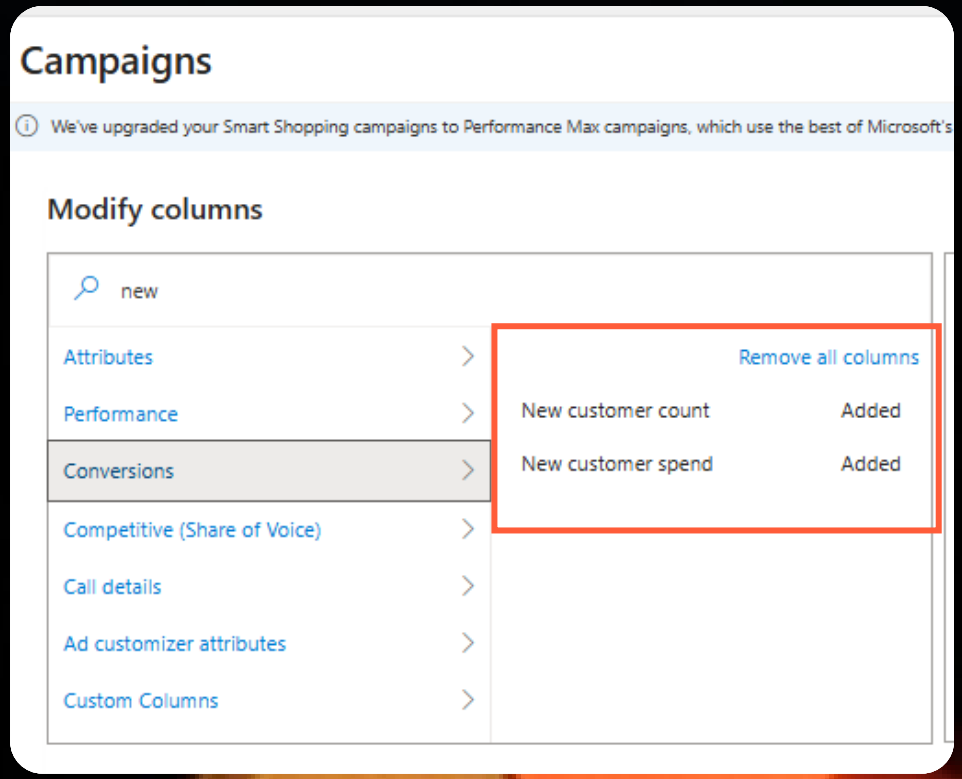
- Exclusively target new customers.
- If you have strict budgets or creative assets for new users vs. returning users or have non-purchase conversion goals like lead generation.
- Also use this if you already have another PMax campaign focused on all customers.

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Reporting options

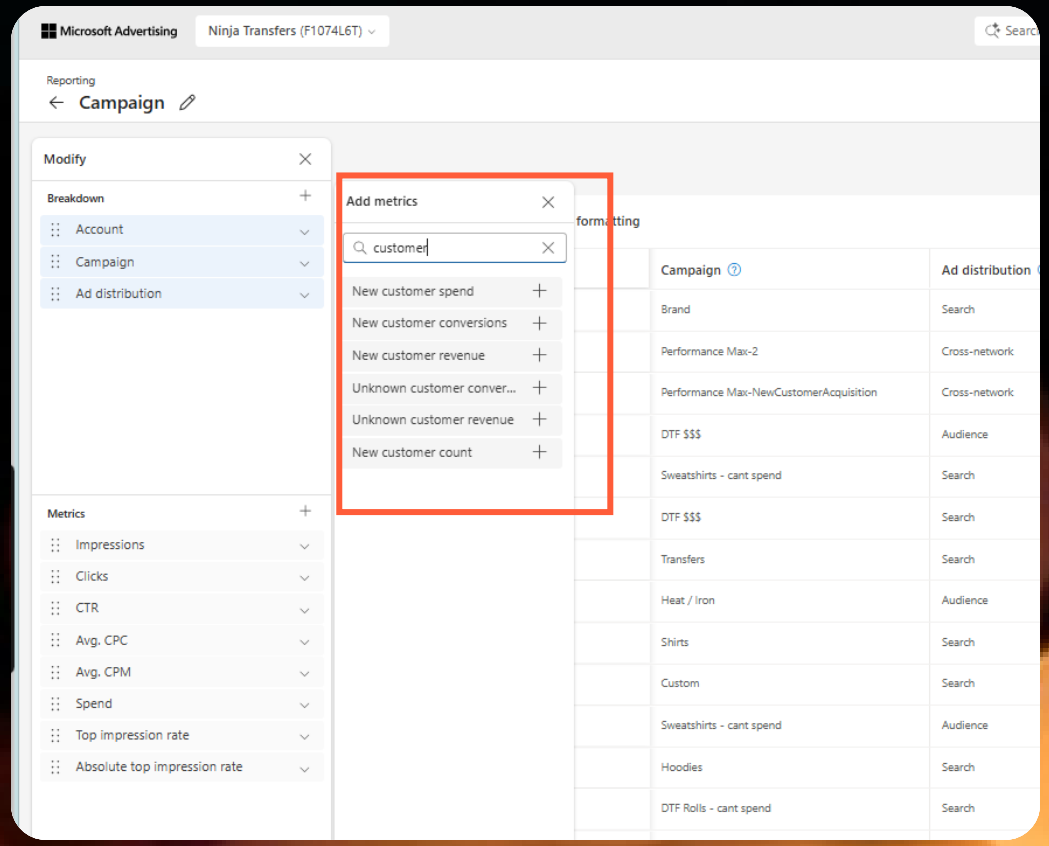
Option 1:

Campaign grid in the UI → Add the respective columns



Option 2:

From the Reporting UI (you'll get more granular data here)



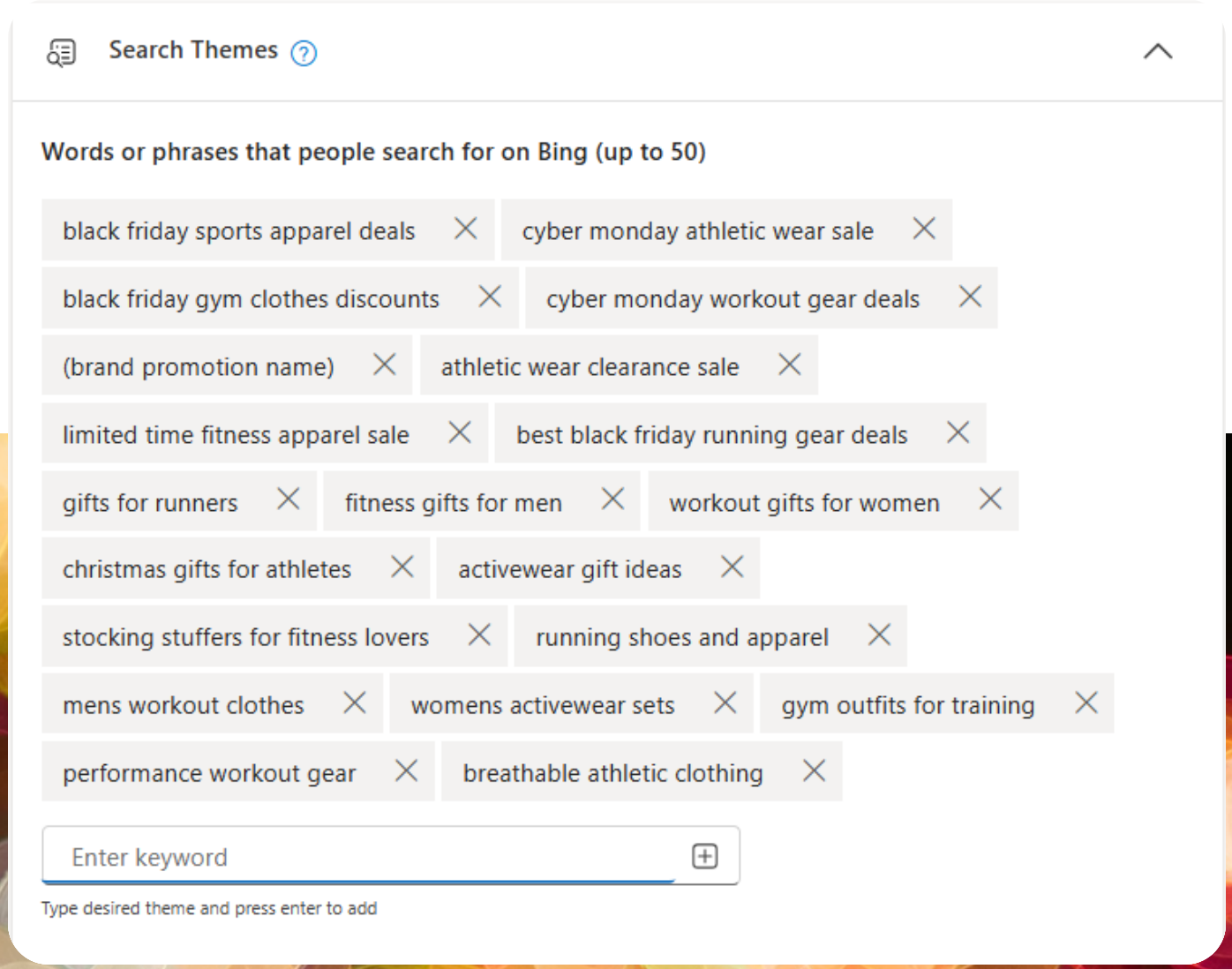
Performance Max

Search themes are additive signals

Seasonal

Travel Tuesday ×
Black Friday Car Rental Discounts ×
Travel Deals ×
(Brand Promotion Name) ×

- **Search Term Insights report** helps identifying high-performing queries
- Search Themes are up to **50**
- They do **not** cap volume



Audience Strategy

Develop Audience strategies early

- Leverage **your First Party Data** for Audiences!
- Build Audience lists early to ensure sufficient scale before peak.
- Separate prospecting and retargeting into distinct campaigns with tailored bids and messaging.
- **In-Market** and **Similar Audiences** are great for acquisition and **prospecting**.
- Build **Remarketing, Dynamic Remarketing, and Customer Match** for **re-engagement** and personalized offers during peak
- **Impression-Based Remarketing** creates audience lists from ad exposure.
- Activate **seasonal audiences** such as Black Friday and Christmas segments.



LinkedIn profile targeting

Target audiences based on their LinkedIn professional profiles

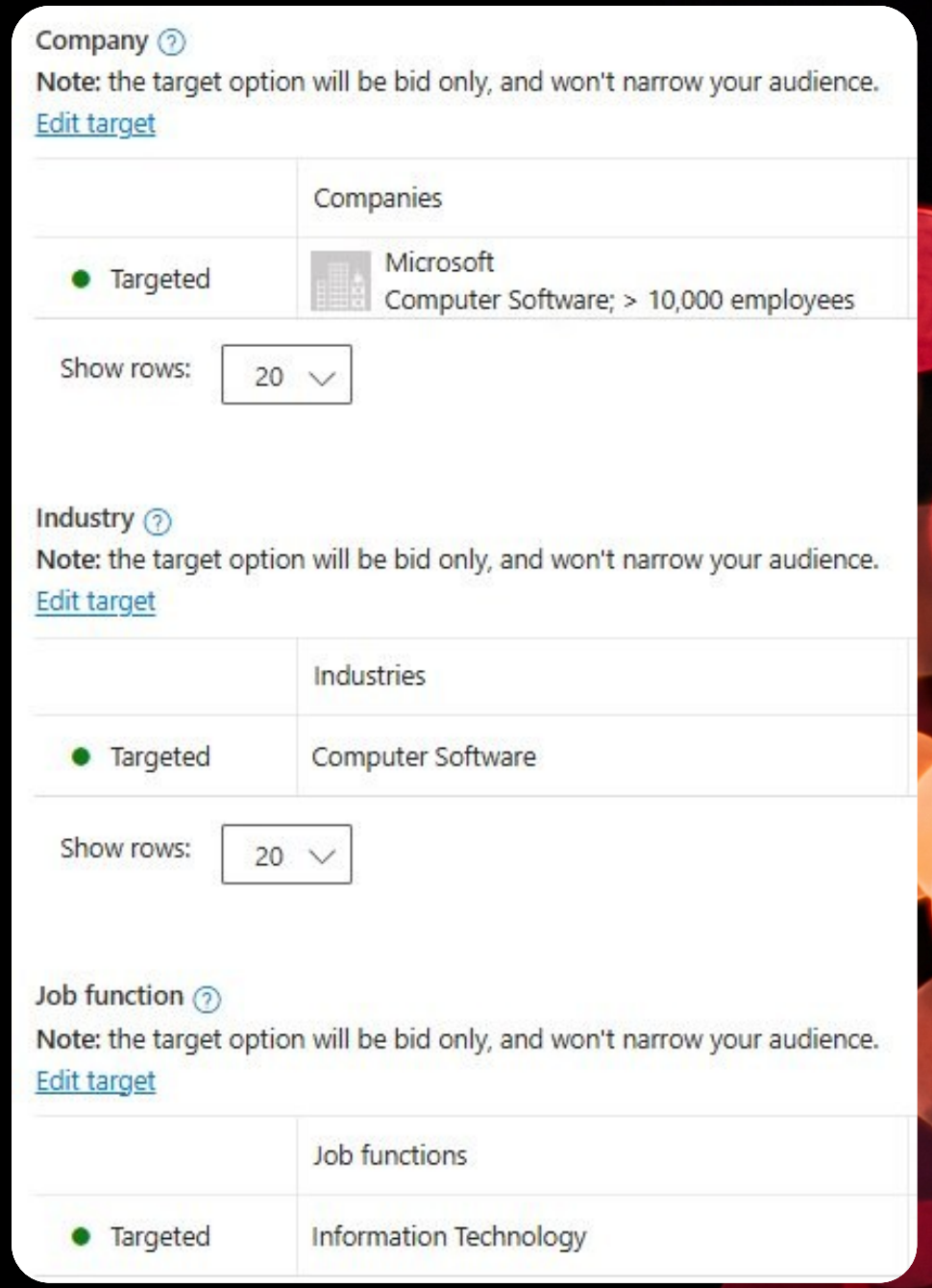
Target highly relevant audiences using LinkedIn profile information across Search and Audience ads
Add as an audience *signal* on Performance Max campaigns.

Company
Example: Microsoft, Verizon, Adobe, etc.

Job function
Example: engineering, sales, consulting, etc.

Industry
Example: retail, banking, marketing, etc.

Job seniority
Example: entry, senior, manager, director, VP, etc.



Audiences

Seasonal in-market audiences

Seasonal segments are lists of people ready to buy for a particular event, like Black Friday or Christmas.

Black Friday segments

US, CA, UK, DE, FR, AU, NZ

- Seasonal shopping/Black Friday shopping.
- Seasonal shopping/Black Friday shopping/in-store Black Friday shopping.
- Seasonal shopping/Black Friday shopping/online Black Friday shopping.

Christmas holiday segments

US, CA, UK, DE, FR, AU, NZ

- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping
- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping/after-Christmas sale shopping
- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping/in-store Christmas shopping
- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping/online Christmas shopping



Cyber-5 generates 9% of holiday conversions with just 7% of clicks as shoppers are highly engaged and ready to purchase.

Source: Microsoft Internal | Demand | Retail & CPG | All Networks | Search Only | US Only

Audience ads

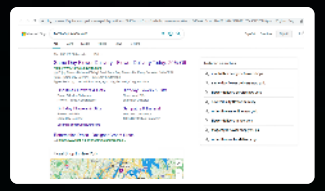
Re-engage audiences with impression-based remarketing

Audience Ads influence 41% of first touchpoints, introducing and nurturing shoppers early in the journey.

Target people who've seen your ads, even if they haven't clicked, with sequential messaging that guides them from initial interest to conversion.

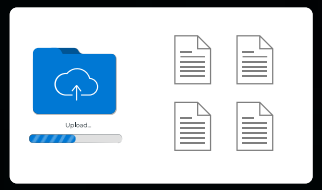
Olivia is in-market for a holiday gift...





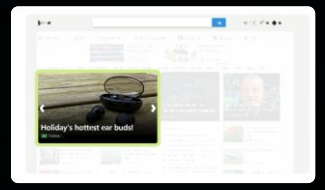
Olivia is searching on Bing for wireless earbuds. She sees your ad, but clicks on a competitor.





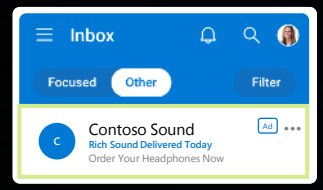
Olivia is placed in your impression-based remarketing list.





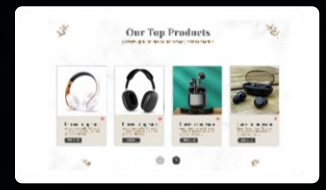
The next day, she visits MSN and sees your ad, keeping your brand top of mind.





Later, while checking emails, she sees your ad, clicks, and visits your site.





Olivia chooses to buy wireless earbuds from your company and checks out on your site.

Microsoft Internal | Holiday Retail Query Pathing Data | Oct – Dec 2025 | UET | US

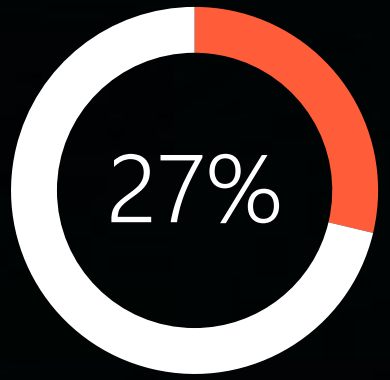
s.Oliver Case Study

By combining festive storytelling with impression-based remarketing, s.Oliver turned passive ad viewers into active customers.

Impression-based remarketing helped this German retailer to achieve:



50x higher CTR compared to other video platforms.



27% conversion rate for impression-based remarketing lists.



10% lower CPM compared to other video platforms.

Microsoft Advertising



Audience ads

"Impression-based remarketing lists have helped us to clearly connect the reach in the upper funnel with the performance in the lower funnel!

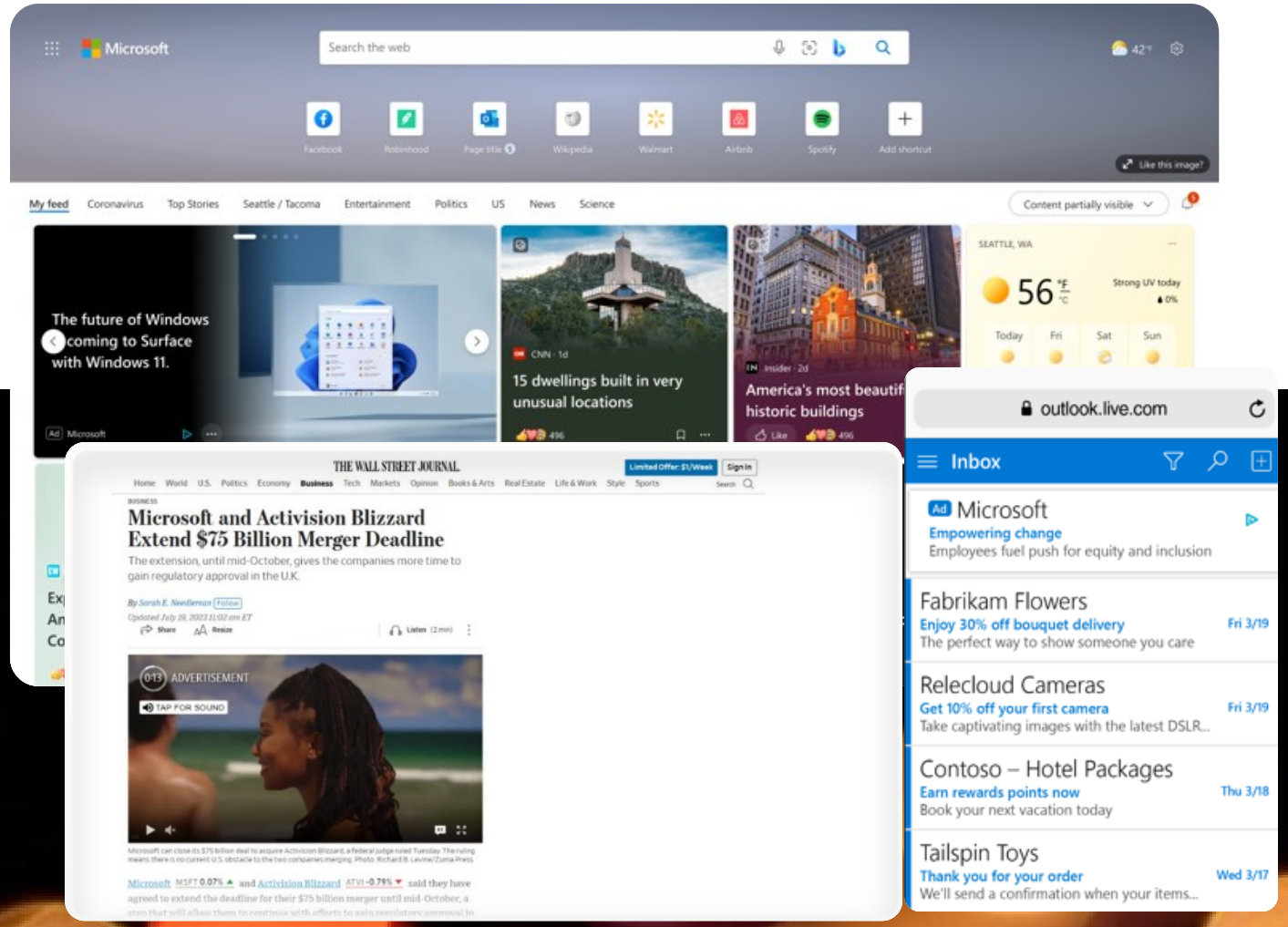
This is why Microsoft Advertising's full-funnel solutions are now a cornerstone of our brand strategy".

Christoph Bornkessel
Head of Brand Strategy, Media & Digital Marketing, s.Oliver

Read more here:
s.Oliver | Microsoft Advertising

Audience ads

Drive higher engagement in contextually relevant environments



Placement targeting

Exclusively serve ads on premium Microsoft properties such as MSN, Outlook, Microsoft Casual Games, King games and more

Topic targeting

Pinpoint specific topics that align with your brand and audience to ensure your ads appear on sites with contextually relevant content

Placement targeting bundles

Choose the placement targeting bundles that best align with your goals

Audience ads

Placement bundle	Publishers	Ad formats	Devices
Microsoft Edge	Microsoft Edge (new tab page)	Native	Desktop
MSN	MSN (all ad placements on MSN)	Native, display, online video	Desktop, mobile, tablet
MSN - Health	MSN Health (all MSN health ad placements*)	Native, display	Desktop, mobile, tablet
MSN - Money	MSN Money (all MSN money/finance ad placements)	Native, display	Desktop, mobile, tablet
Productivity	Outlook	Native, display	Desktop, mobile, tablet
Gaming	Microsoft Casual Games	Display, online video	Desktop, mobile, tablet
	MSN Gaming	Native, display	Desktop
	King (e.g. Candy Crush Saga)	Online video	Mobile

Choose the topics that align with your customers' interests

- Arts & entertainment
- Autos & vehicles
- Beauty & fitness
- Books & literature
- Business & industrial
- Computers & electronics
- Finance
- Food & drink
- Games
- Health
- Hobbies & leisure
- Home & garden
- Internet & telecom
- Jobs & education
- Law & government
- News
- Online communities
- People & Society
- Pets & animals
- Real estate
- Reference
- Science
- Shopping
- Sports
- Travel
- Transportation
- World localities

Case study

LOOKFANTASTIC

Turns beauty trends into cart conversions



The challenge

- Traditionally relied on lower-funnel Search campaigns to capture existing demand
- Needed to engage beauty shoppers earlier in the purchase journey amid intense competition

The objective

- Determine whether upper-funnel media investment could drive measurable business outcomes beyond awareness

The solution

- **Build attention at scale and reinforce the message using Audience ads:** The team could reach beauty shoppers while competitors focused heavily on search. Image-led Native formats kept their brand top of mind.
- **Turn views into action through impression-based remarketing:** The strategy reconnected users who had seen ads and re-engaged them through Search when they were ready to buy.
- **Activate high-intent signals using Microsoft in-market audiences:** First-party data and customer match layering helped balance prospecting and re-engagement with in-market audiences.

The results

2.7x Conversion lift from in-market audiences

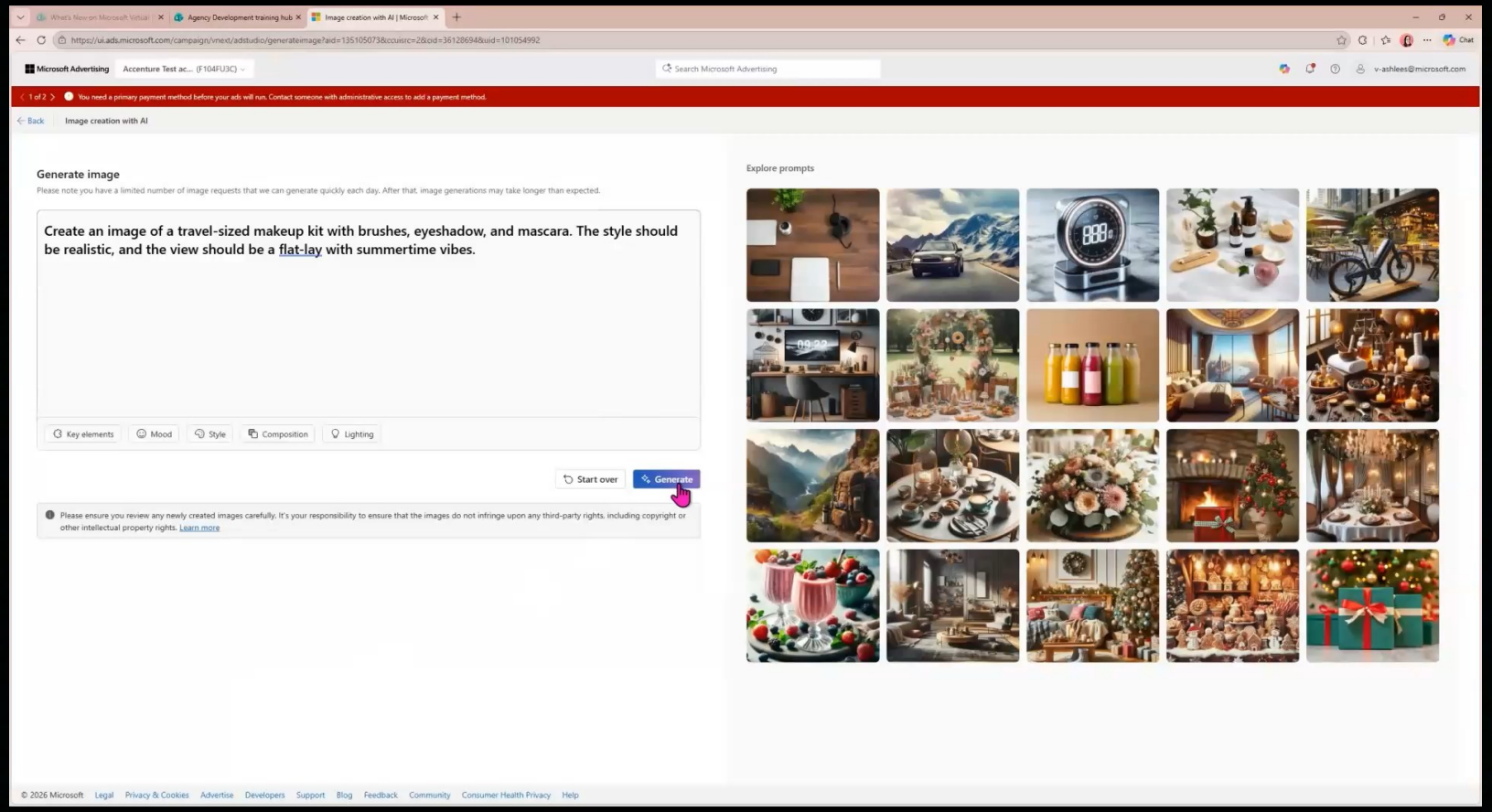
76% Video view-through rate

56% Revenue generated from remarketing

Copilot in MAP

Refine your assets for holiday with Ads Studio

- Type in a text prompt to generate a new background
- Hover over example images to see example prompts
- Click **Apply background** to add to your library. Saved as a copy to your original image.



Microsoft Advertising Platform

Classified as Microsoft Confidential

Creative best practices

Minimum images needed for asset groups
At least one image with 1.91:1 ratio and one image with 1:1 ratio

Choose **compelling images. No text** overlays

Leverage the **Ad Preview tool for aspect ratios**

Turn on auto-generated assets to improve performance

Leverage Assets reporting for optimization

Customize assets background based on campaign structure and audience signals with **Copilot** in Microsoft Advertising Platform

Make your assets seasonal

- Lead with **holiday** or gifting-oriented **messaging**. Highlight promotions, special product bundles, and other differentiators.
- **Refresh creative** to match user's intent:
  - Introduce gift ideas and inspiration-focused creative to build awareness.
  - Retarget with relevant products and offers to drive consideration.
  - Drive urgency with promotions, shipping deadlines, or limited offers closer to purchase.
- Provide multiple aspect ratios and creative variations. Use the **Ad Preview tool**
- Leverage **Ads Studio** to build AI-generated seasonal assets and Assets reporting for optimization.

CHRISTMAS ATMOSPHERE



HALLOWEEN SCENE



LUNAR NEW YEAR

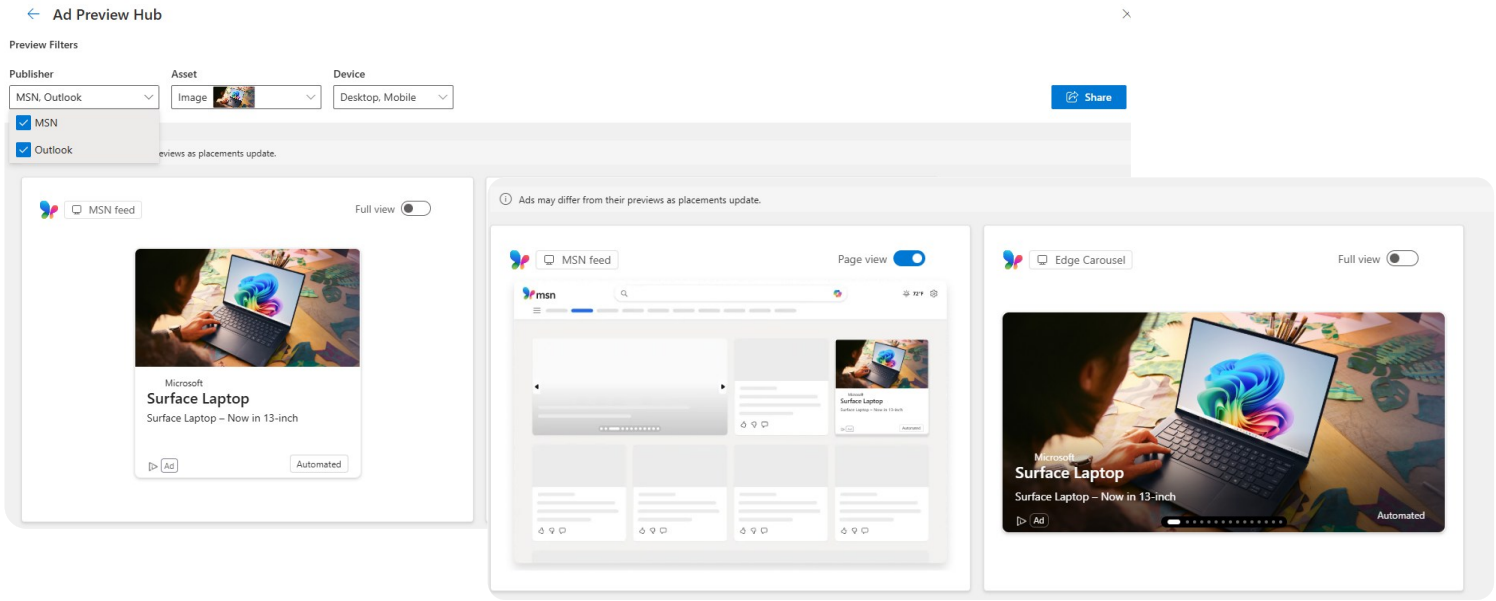


VALENTINE'S DAY SCENE



Ad preview hub

Now available for Audience ads and Performance Max



Preview before you publish

See exactly how your ads will appear across placements, formats, and devices so you can launch with confidence and avoid costly surprises.

Validate creative quality at scale

Quickly review headlines, descriptions, images, logos, and videos together to identify gaps, inconsistencies, or formatting issues before they impact performance.

Streamline collaboration and approvals

Give marketers, creatives, and stakeholders a single destination to review ad experiences, align on execution, and accelerate campaign launch timelines.

Please complete your advertiser identity verification (AIV). Complete verification Learn more about AIV

Assets
Targeting
Campaign details
Budget
Summary

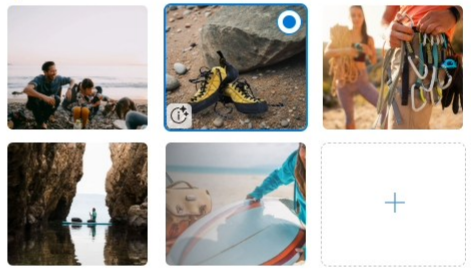
Refine Remove assets

Add assets

Provide your assets and we'll automatically determine what your ads look like, where and when they appear, and who sees them.

Images

You can add up to 20 images to your ad. We recommend that you add two to three relevant images. Required aspect ratios: 1.91:1 and 1:1. Minimum image upload dimensions: 703 x 368 pixels.



Recommended images Preview ads Generate



Logos

You can add up to 5 different logos. Each logo can have one or both 4:1 aspect ratio and 1:1 aspect ratio.



MSN Bing Search Outlook

Preview ads Edit aspect ratio Exclude



Adventure Works

Your Gear, Your Adventure

Shop now for top-quality outdoor gear a...

Ad

These are examples of how your ads could appear. Depending on placement, the actual ad may appear differently.

Save & go to next step Cancel

Gift them a reason — demand creation checklist

Use this time to create consideration, build reachable audiences, and refresh the seasonal message before shoppers are ready to buy.

Audience development

- ☐ Build remarketing, Customer Match, dynamic remarketing, and impression-based lists now.
- ☐ Activate seasonal in-market, similar audience, LinkedIn, and new-customer acquisition strategies.
- ☐ Use placement and topic targeting to show up in relevant Microsoft environments.

Creative & context

- ☐ Refresh creative with seasonal offers, gift, and urgency angles ahead of October demand.
- ☐ Use Ads Studio / Copilot to adapt product imagery and backgrounds for each moment.

Performance Max

- ☐ Add top-volume search themes to PMax campaigns as additive signals.
- ☐ Set up new customer acquisition when higher new-customer value is justified.

Bidding & readiness

- ☐ Monitor targets and budgets during the ramp; avoid budget limits that suppress demand.
- ☐ Confirm automated bidding and Google Import settings are stable before peak.

Microsoft Advertising

Phase 03: Ring in the sales!



Phase 03

Ring in the sales – **Peak Capture**

Capture demand at peak moments

- Ensure campaigns are **fully optimized** and ready to scale
- Maximize reach and efficiency with **Performance Max** and **AI Max**
- Schedule **promotions** in advance to support key shopping events
- Maintain **sufficient budget headroom** to capture rising demand

Stay agile throughout the season

- **Refresh creative assets** regularly to prevent fatigue
- **Evolve audience strategies** as shopper behavior changes
- Monitor performance daily to **identify optimization opportunities**

Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions

Phase 03:



“The competitive landscape is static throughout the season.”

“Shopping campaigns don't need optimization.”

“There are so many shoppers, promotions aren’t necessary.”

- Feed quality, product titles, images, offers, and pricing all can impact performance.
- Holiday demand doesn't guarantee sales. Consumers are actively comparing prices, deals, and brands. Promotions, seasonal messaging, and compelling offers can help capture attention, improve conversion rates, and maximize your share of holiday demand.

October clicks fuel conversions well into the holiday season

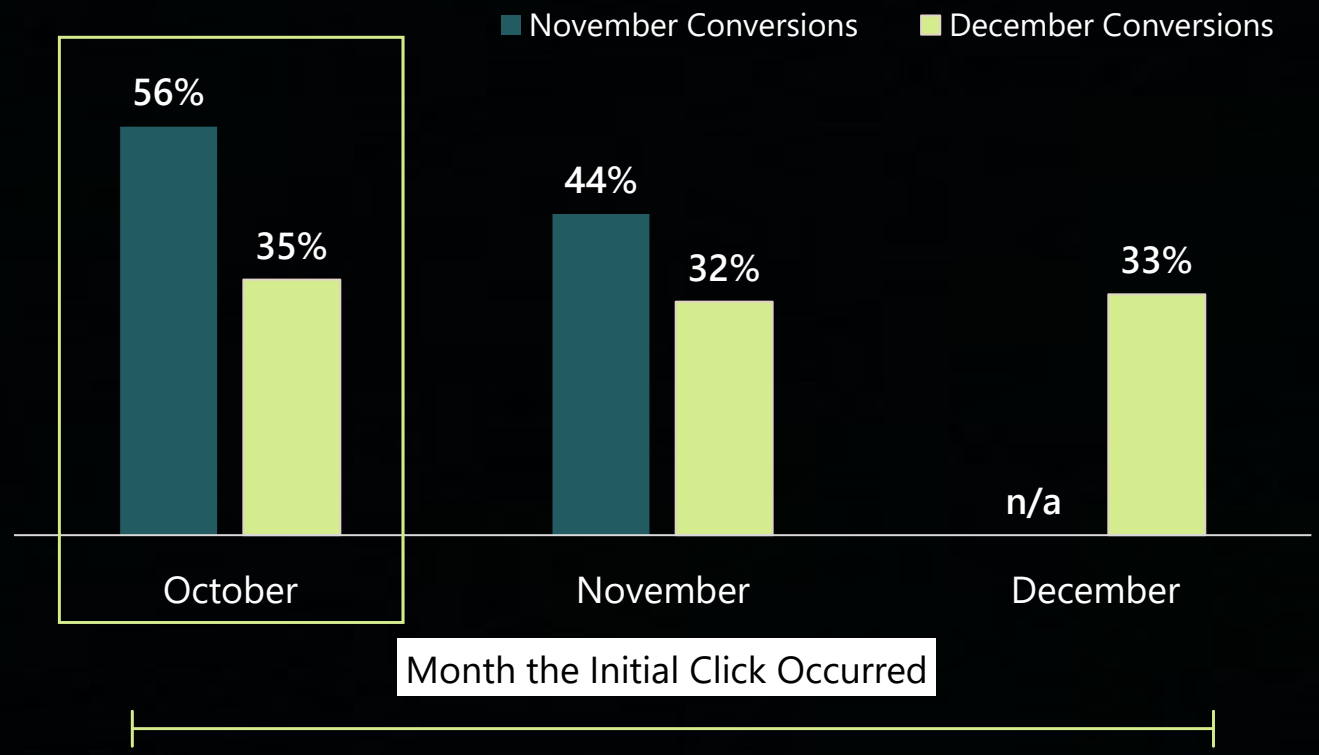
Among nearly 500K holiday user paths, October was a key starting point as **56% of November** conversions and **35% of December conversions** originated from October clicks.

October was the starting point for **56% of November** and **35% of December conversions.**

56%
Nov Conv

35%
Dec Conv

✓ Use October to drive more cost-efficient site traffic, build remarketing lists, and re-engage high-intent shoppers in November and December.



Sales events are now the default

As shopping becomes more event-led, these key moments are becoming essential drivers of growth

82%

of respondents **shopped** a sales event last year.

87%

of respondents **plan to shop** a sales event this year.

✓ **Plan for always-on coverage with PMax to maintain presence before, during, and after events, to capture both early planners and last-minute shoppers.**

Microsoft 1P Survey | 15-min online study | n=1024 | US Only | Must have purchased from a Retail subcategory within the last year

Making a list, checking it twice: Product feed audit checklist – **Phase 3**



Pro tip: Use Product explorer in Merchant Center to easily view all products in your catalog, audit, and identify issues.

Highlight holiday shopping details, deals, and incentives.

- ☐ **Sale prices**
  Show your discounted price
- ☐ **Pricing accuracy**
  Keep pricing and availability accurate in real time.
- ☐ **Merchant promotions**
  Offer shopping incentives like buy 1 get 1 free, discount codes, $20 off $100, etc.
- ☐ **Local Inventory ads**
  Show local inventory availability
- ☐ **Curbside pickup**
- ☐ **Free Shipping**
- ☐ **Monitor feed health**
  Audit the feed for disapprovals and missing attributes daily through peak
- ☐ **Additional images**
  Show shoppers multiple product views.

AI Max delivers stronger conversion performance **focused on Search**

New demand

Find new performant queries that go beyond the exact terms you're bidding on

Smarter ads

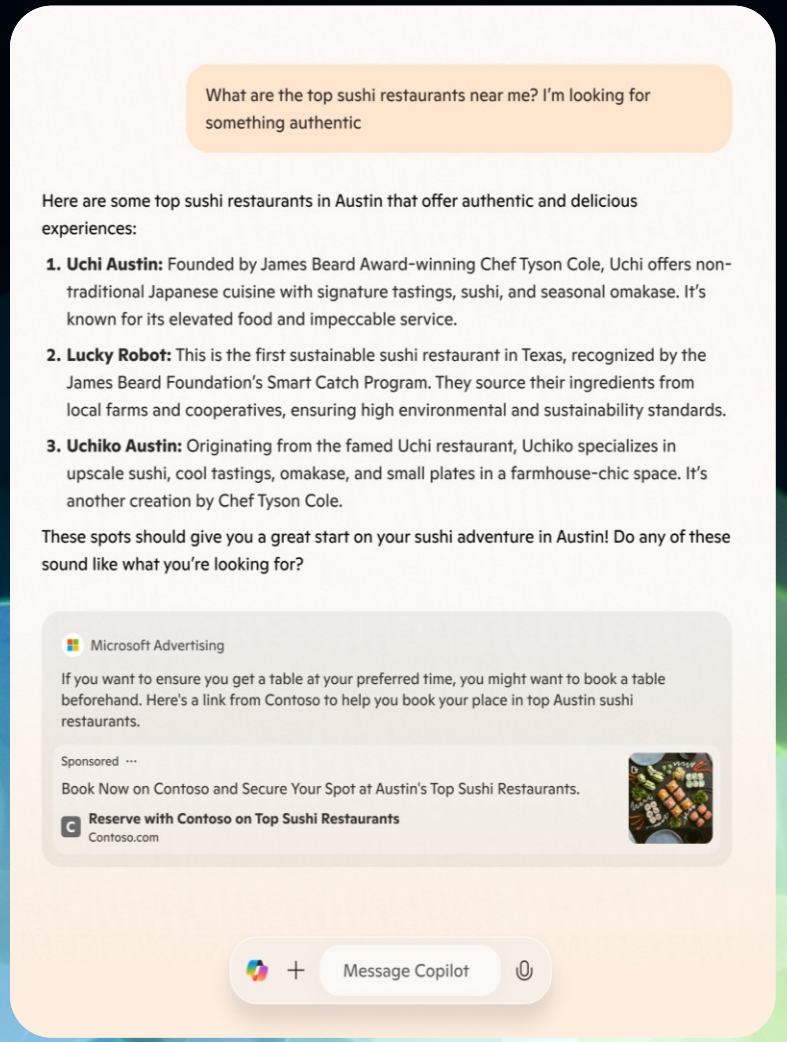
Dynamically customize your creative and route people to your most relevant landing pages based on user intent

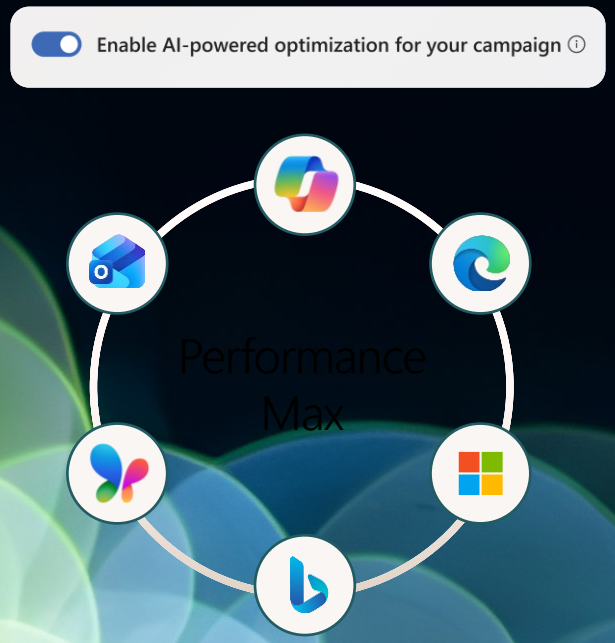
Brand controls

Keep your campaign true to your brand with controls like brand inclusions and exclusions, term inclusions and messaging guidelines

PHASE 03 – AI MAX

AI Max and PMax help you deliver better AI-native ads on Bing and Copilot

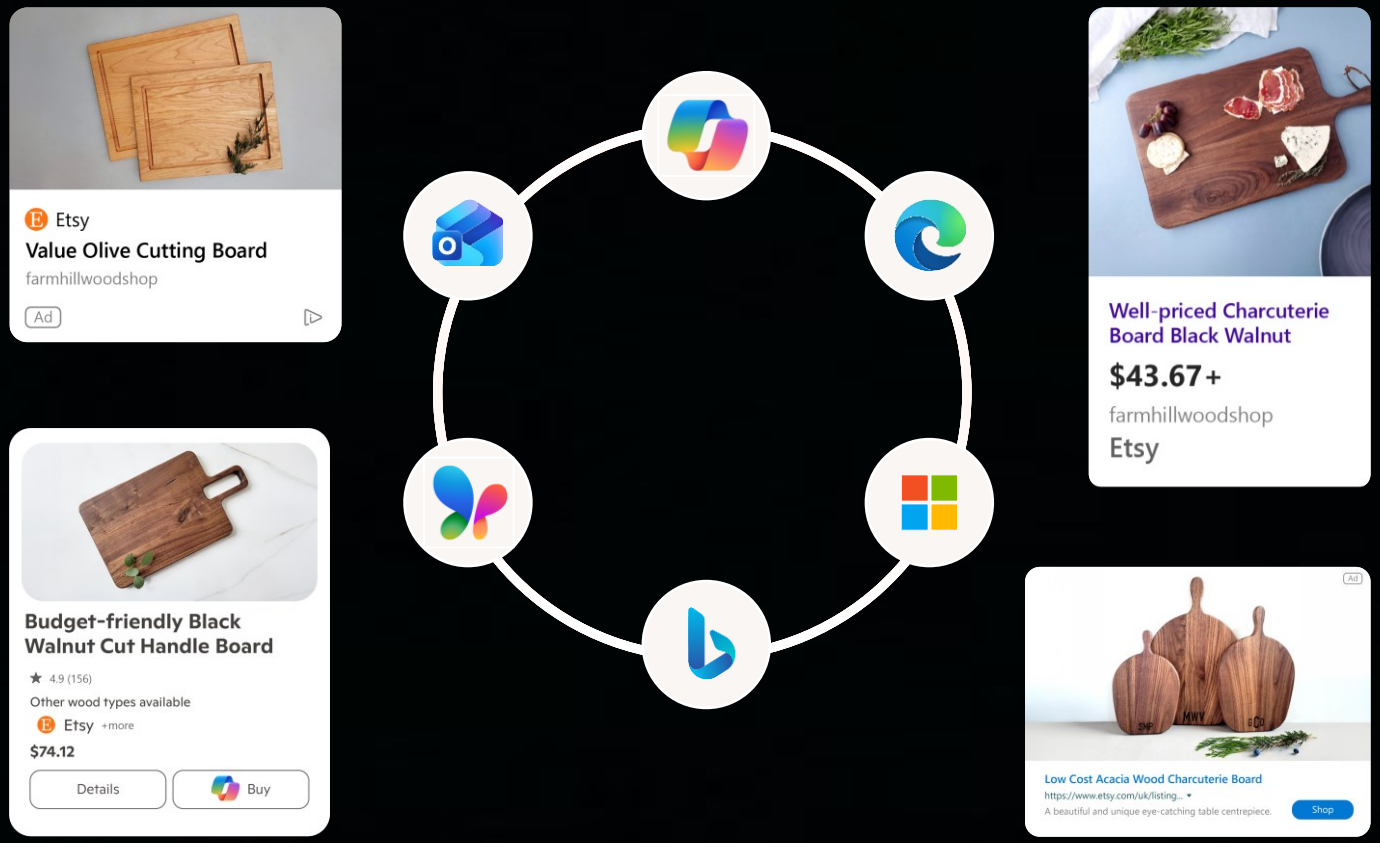




Only AI Max and Performance Max have the ability to adapt to evolving consumer behavior—by using AI to reach increasingly complex queries and generate relevant creative in Copilot in real-time.

This helps your campaigns stay resilient as consumer journeys become more conversational, compressed, and intent-rich.

AI-powered Performance Max helps you drive more conversions across Microsoft properties and formats



+8%

increase in incremental conversions

Performance Max best practices

SET UP FOR SUCCESS

- **Verify conversion tracking** with an existing goal (2+ weeks of history) and upload offline conversions regularly.
- **Keep your feed healthy:** (valid GTINs, correct pricing) and allow a 72-hour feed ramp.
- **Launch new assets early:** Upload paused 48 hours ahead for editorial, then activate as early as possible (up to a 1-day ramp).
- **Refresh Customer Match lists:** These take up to 24 hours to process — refresh them ahead of key moments.

MAXIMIZE PEAK DEMAND

- **Add more budget** so campaigns aren't budget-constrained and can capture incremental traffic.
- **Search themes are a must:** Add diverse, top-volume queries from search term insights, plus new products and promotions.
- **Seasonal in-market audiences:** Target Black Friday, Christmas holiday, and more.
- **Seasonality adjustments & value rules:** Leverage both to guide bidding.

No conversion goals? Use other campaign types (search, audience) with Maximize Clicks or Enhanced CPC, plus merchant promotions, promotion and price extensions, sitelinks, callouts, image extensions, and countdown customizers.

What to consider when adding in new assets, ad groups, campaigns for short-term promotions on Performance Max:

Existing account -> new PMax campaign

- Consider this scenario if:
  - Separate budget / KPIs determined for promotion
  - More control over specific budgets and bids
  - Ability to monitor holiday-specific assets separately

Existing account -> existing PMax campaign

- Consider this scenario if:
  - There is not a specific KPI related to the promotion
  - If so, add new assets to the existing Performance Max campaign(s).

Pro Tips:
As long as you're working within an existing account with conversion history:
-there is no difference in ramp time for new assets in any campaign
-no lever for 'weighting' holiday assets against evergreen assets
For new assets that you're looking to run during holiday, try to launch as early as possible:
-upload assets as paused >48hrs in advance to ensure there is time for editorial approvals
-set your assets active as early as you can to optimize for best performance.
**Our system can take up to one day to ramp fully for all ad types*

Target and budget considerations

Leverage the bid landscape tool

Create a simulation of your campaign's performance using different targets.

Campaign bid landscape

Create a simulation of your campaign's performance using different Target ROAS. Learn more

Target ROAS	Weekly est. spend	Weekly est. clicks	Weekly est. Impr.	Weekly est. top Impr.	Weekly est. conv.	Weekly est. conv. value	Additional budget/daily required
1,920.00%	$5,713.96	6,534	69,046	27,908	738	78,079	-
1,560.00%	$5,830.78	6,607	70,337	29,199	744	78,622	-
1,200.00%	$6,062.02	6,750	72,893	31,755	756	79,697	-
1,080.00%	$6,199.24	6,836	74,409	33,271	763	80,334	-
840.00%	$6,596.11	7,045	80,148	39,010	779	81,650	-
600.00%	$7,231.08	7,291	90,368	49,230	797	82,490	-
240.00%	$8,928.51	7,632	107,799	66,661	815	84,020	-
Other	%						



Apply to my campaign | Cancel

*This simulation is based on performance from 11/25/2024 to 12/1/2024. These are estimated figures and do not guarantee future results.

Black Friday and Cyber Monday fall at month-end — monitor budget pacing so you aren't constrained in the peak moments.

Reminder: Avoid capping your budgets.

Use ***targets*** to control spend.

Set conversion value rules towards your performance goals

Apply Seasonality Adjustments for peak

Phase budget changes in 15% - 20% increments gradually as early as possible to avoid scaling issues.

Classified as Microsoft Confidential

During the peak days, monitor and optimize closely

Loosen CPA or ROAS targets to give auto-bidding more room to compete in holiday auctions. Only make incremental changes to bids/budgets (+/- 15%) gradually.

If using Enhanced CPC, continuously optimize base bids as one of most important levers

Set conversion value rules towards your performance goals.

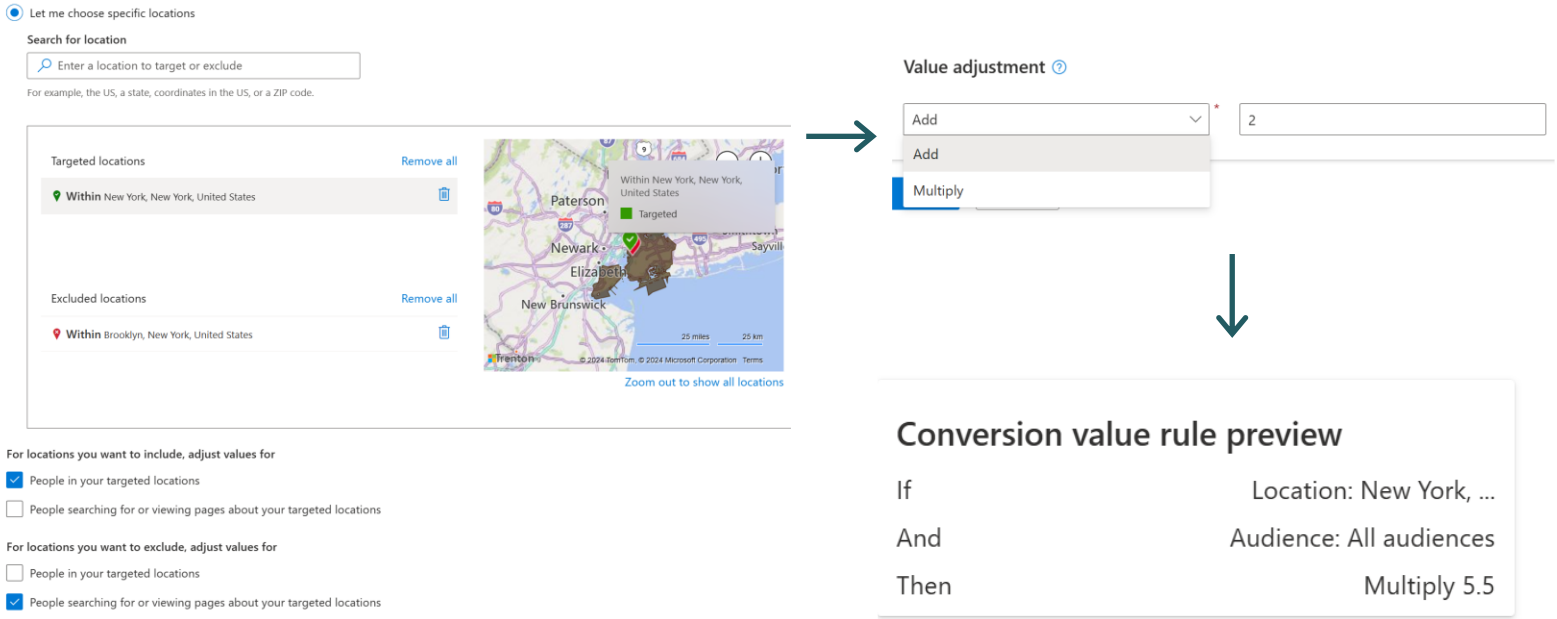
Apply Seasonality Adjustments

Conversion value rules

Better express the value of conversions as they relate to your business

Conversion value rules allow you to adjust your conversion values if the conversion meets certain conditions (or rules) that may be relevant to your business goals. You can set conditions for **locations, devices**, and **audiences**.

Example:



Optimize your true business goals
Better reflect your business' data and optimize to what matters, like revenue or lifetime value.

Simplified management
Enhance reporting and optimization directly from your Microsoft account, without having to change any tagging code.

Control your message
Conversion value rules allow you to optimize for nuanced values in real-time with conversion-based automated bidding strategies (Target ROAS and Maximize Conversion Value only)

Note: Currently only supported at the account level, not campaign level

Currently does not support store visit goals

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Ring in the sales — peak capture checklist

During this time, protect delivery, keep offers visible, and use automation signals to capture the holiday moments shoppers are ready to act on.

Peak execution

- ☐ Schedule promotions, sale prices, shipping, and local inventory details ahead of key dates.
- ☐ Check feed health daily for disapprovals, pricing, images, and availability issues.
- ☐ Maintain budget headroom for Cyber Week and avoid CPC caps that limit delivery.

Auto-bidding & PMax

- ☐ Use targets, bid landscape, and conversion value rules to steer toward revenue or LTV.
- ☐ Loosen CPA or ROAS targets to give auto-bidding more room to compete in holiday auctions. Only make incremental changes to bids/budgets (+/-15%) gradually.
- ☐ Use seasonality adjustments & value rules to guide bidding.

Creative & Audiences

- ☐ Set up new customer acquisition when higher new-customer value is justified.
- ☐ Refresh creative and audiences daily based on performance signals and product demand.



Phase 04: Unbox what's next!

Microsoft Advertising

Phase 04

Unbox what's next – **Measurement & learning**

1. Monitor performance

- Monitor **post-holiday performance** to identify new opportunities
- Account for **conversion delays** before evaluating campaign success
- Use **performance insights and KPIs** to identify optimization opportunities

2. Adapt strategies & messaging

- Refine **bids, targets, budgets,** and **messaging** as consumer behavior evolves
- **Adjust strategies** to align with changing demand and seasonal priorities

3. Apply insights & grow

- Apply learnings to build momentum and **capture continued growth** post Holiday rush

Assets

Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions

Phase 04: **From last-minute shoppers to lasting insights**

When shoppers are ready to buy



"It's too late to influence holiday purchases in the final days."

"Gift card purchases are the end of the customer journey."

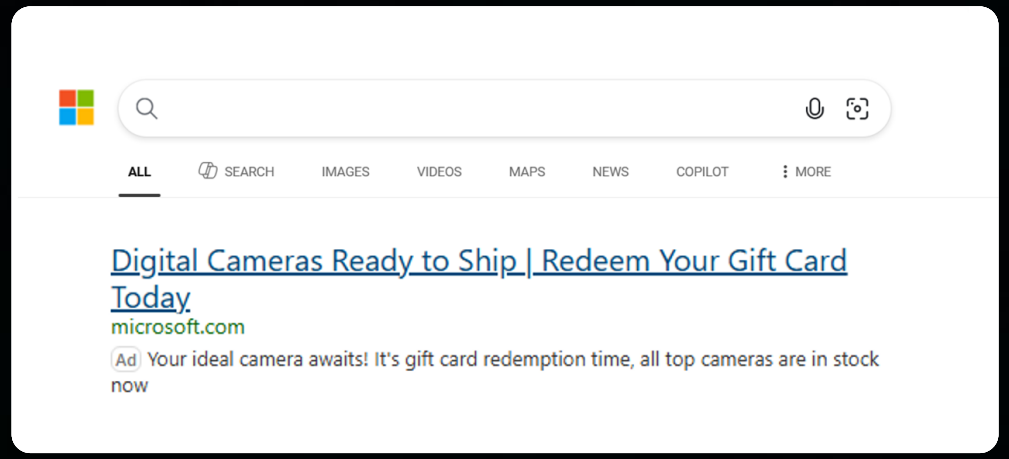
"Consumer spending drops immediately after the holidays."

- Many shoppers pivot to digital options such as gift cards, memberships, subscriptions, and online certificates when physical delivery is no longer guaranteed.
- Last-minute shoppers are highly motivated and often make quick decisions. Urgency-focused messaging, gift guides, and instant-delivery options can drive strong conversion rates.
- Gift cards create a second opportunity to engage customers when recipients redeem them, often generating additional purchases beyond the card's value.
- Post-holiday shopping remains strong as consumers redeem gift cards, take advantage of clearance sales, and purchase items they delayed during the holiday rush.

Assets

Post-holiday messaging

Run dedicated **gift-card redemption campaigns** with bonus-value offers and upgrade promotions.



Extend urgency through limited-time post-holiday and clearance events.

Refresh creative to align with post-holiday shopper intent and New Year motivations.



Post-holiday is still a conversion window

Help shoppers finish, exchange, redeem, and save — not just “treat yourself.”

1. **Late shoppers**
   Promote gift cards, subscriptions, and instant digital delivery.
2. **Exchanges & returns**
   Offer easy swaps, alternatives, bundles, and reorder prompts.
3. **Post-holiday sales**
   Use clearance, bonus value, and New Year reset messaging.
4. **Gift cards**
   Nudge redemption with add-ons, upgrades, and reminder campaigns.

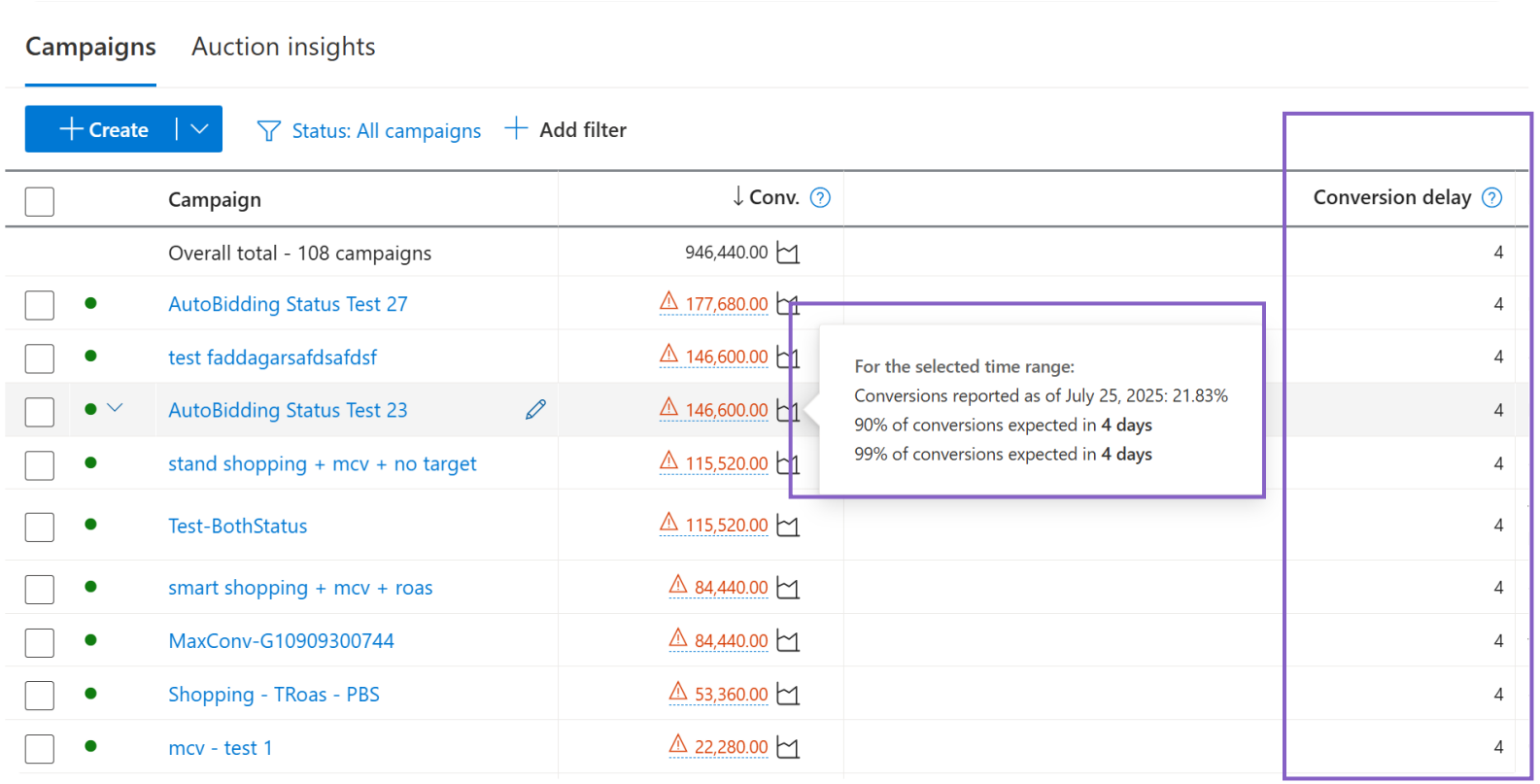
Keep messaging active → finish it • fix it • redeem it • save now

Right after the peak days, continue monitoring closely and be gradual with changes

1. Adjust bids and targets as needed to continue meeting your KPIs
2. Do not change bid strategies, continue running as-is

Reminder: Check conversion delays when analyzing your performance

Showcasing conversion delay helps advertisers make more informed decisions by revealing how long it typically takes users to convert after interacting with an ad, enabling better attribution, budgeting, and campaign optimization.



Real time insights
Visibility into current progress on click to conversion, projecting duration when 90% and 99% of clicks to conversion over times.

Simplified management
Effortlessly view insights displayed directly as a new metric with a column and a simple hover on conversions.

Note: conversion delay data is only available after 06/01/2025. For any selected time range including 06/01/2025, we will only return conversion delay data after 06/01/2025.

Conversions API

a server-to-server solution that allows you to share your first-party data—online, offline, CRM, and app—directly with Microsoft Advertising, in real time.

Integrated with leading third-party platforms, some of those are:

Adobe · Freshpaint · INVOCA · Stape · twilio Segment · TEALIUM

Microsoft Advertising



Search lift measurement for Audience Ads

Search lift

Are users more likely to **search for your brand** after being exposed to Audience ads?

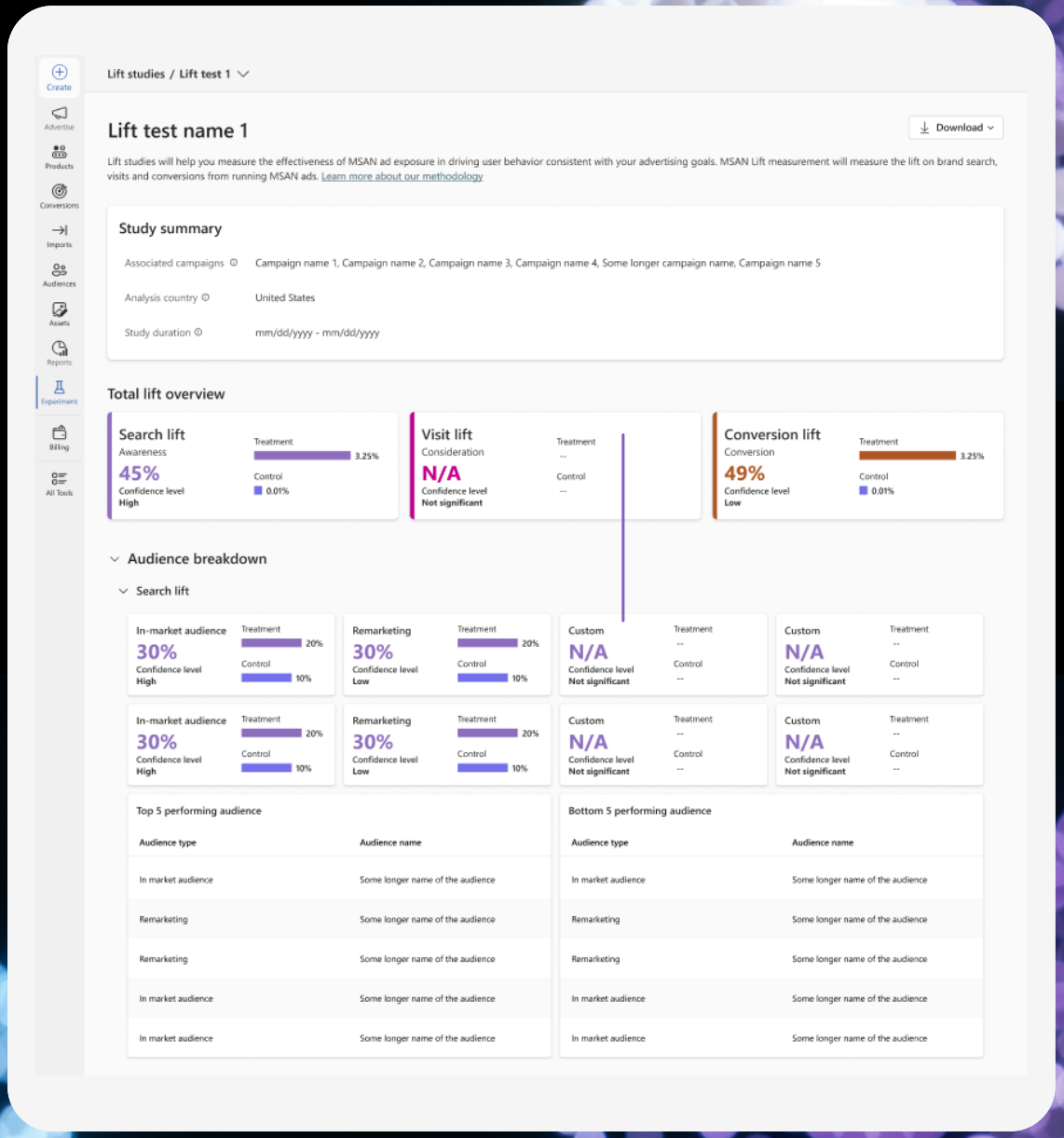
Visit lift

Are users more likely to **visit your website** after being exposed to Audience ads?

Conversion lift

Are users more likely to **convert** after being exposed to Audience ads?

Contact your Microsoft Rep to test it!



Unbox what's next — measurement & learning checklist

After peak, keep momentum moving: pivot the message, measure with conversion delays in mind, and capture learnings for the next holiday cycle.

Post-holiday demand

- ☐ Pivot messaging to gift cards, digital delivery, clearance, returns, and New Year goals.
- ☐ Run redemption or bonus-value offers to extend the customer journey.
- ☐ Keep campaigns live for last-minute and post-holiday shoppers; adjust gradually.

Measurement

- ☐ Account for conversion delays before judging late-season performance.
- ☐ Review KPIs by phase, audience, campaign type, product set, and offer.
- ☐ Compare learnings from October clicks, Cyber Week, and December / January demand.

Next-season actions

- ☐ Document which feed, audience, creative, bidding, and budget moves worked.
- ☐ Turn findings into next year's testing roadmap and early setup checklist.

Tie the bow— holiday readiness core checklist

Use this final pass to confirm the foundation, demand creation, peak capture, and learning motions are ready across the full holiday cycle.

PHASE 01

Wrap the basics

- ☐ Media strategy ready - Search, Shopping, AI Max, PMax, and Audience ads
- ☐ Product feed & UCP set
- ☐ UET and goals validated
- ☐ Active Conversion values
- ☐ Experiments set

PHASE 02

Gift them a reason

- ☐ Audience lists built
- ☐ Seasonal signals activated (PMax search themes & audiences)
- ☐ New-customer value reviewed
- ☐ Creative refreshed early
- ☐ Placements and topics aligned
- ☐ Bidding/import settings stable

PHASE 03

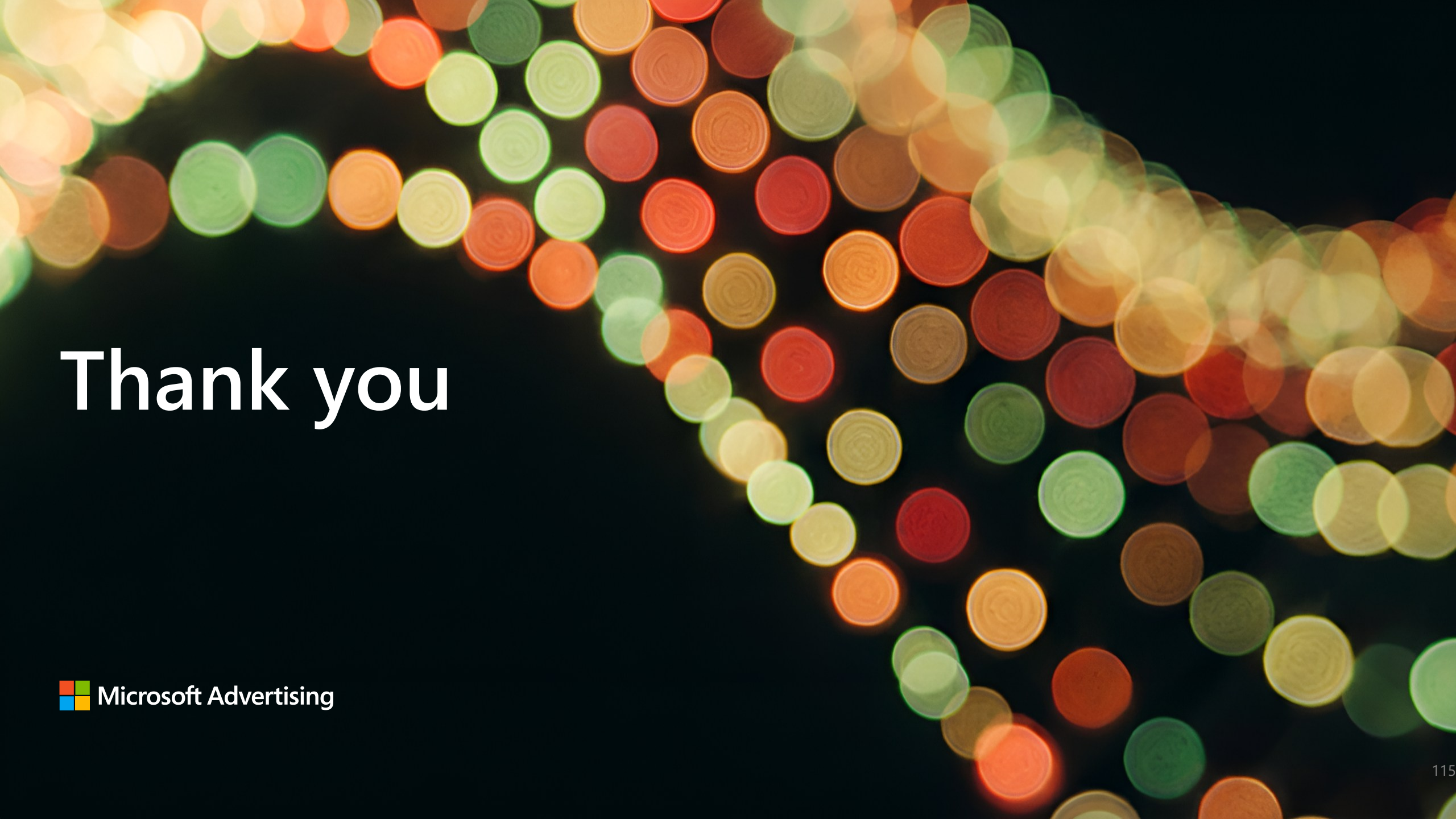
Ring in the sales

- ☐ Promotions scheduled
- ☐ Feed health checked daily
- ☐ Peak budget headroom secured
- ☐ Loosen CPA or ROAS targets to compete in holiday auctions.
- ☐ Slow, incremental changes to bids/budgets (+/-15%)
- ☐ Use existing account when possible

PHASE 04

Unbox what's next

- ☐ Post-holiday message pivoted
- ☐ Conversion delays accounted for
- ☐ KPIs reviewed by phase
- ☐ Learnings documented
- ☐ Next-year roadmap started


Thank you
Microsoft Advertising

Thank you



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